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SOMETHING I CAN CONTROL

women rush to get IUDs after Trump's election

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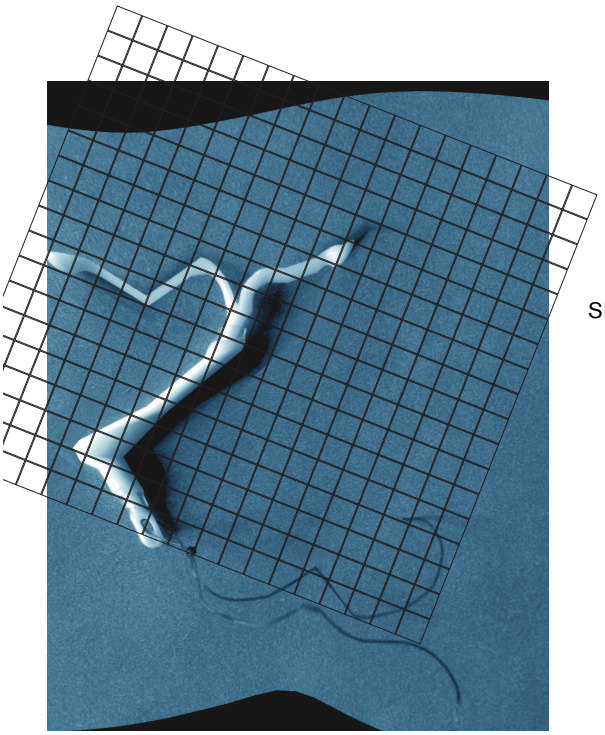

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PRIVATE SPEECH MADE PUBLIC

A YALE FACEBOOK PROFESSOR'S COMMENT GOES VIRAL

BY – LILY EISSENBERG MOORE

"FUCK THOSE ASSHOLES. Seriously. I stand with you, Kate Abramson," Yale philosophy professor Jason Stanley commented in a private Facebook thread in September. "Those assholes" referred to people defending Oxford emeritus professor of philosophy Richard Swinburne, who had argued that homosexuality was a disability, provoking outcry from many philosophers. In response, Kate Abramson, an associate professor of philosophy at Indiana University, expressed her "anger, outrage, and sheer exhaustion" in a Facebook post. She tagged Stanley, an outspoken progressive who had been vocal in last year's national debate over free speech on college campuses.

The comment thread was kept private until *Rightly Considered*—a conservative philosophy blog with the tagline, "For Philosophers Who Are Right"—posted screenshots of the conversation online.

"The debate was no longer just about homosexuality—it was about free speech."

Stanley soon found himself at the center of an online firestorm. At a faculty meeting, a colleague told him that the blog had published his comment and asked if he understood "the enormity of the situation." It was not until then, Stanley recalled in an interview with *The Politic*, that he grasped just how much attention his comment would attract.

Within days, Rod Dreher, blogger and Editor-in-Chief of *The American Conservative*, launched a series of scathing opinion pieces condemning what he termed the "hysterical nature" of Stanley's comment and of left-wing philosophers in general. His was the first attack of many published by right-wing media outlets. Dreher argued that "radical progressive ideologues" were trying to suppress the free speech rights of those who disagreed with them.

The debate was no longer just about homosexuality—it was about free speech.

Stanley's were not the only words screenshotted and published by *Rightly Considered*. Elizabeth Barnes, associate professor of philosophy at the University of Virginia and pseudonymous blogger for *Feminist Philosophers*, said the blog "transposed" her words, "totally twisting [them]." Barnes' post criticized those who think that their need to say whatever they like without pushback "trump[s] basic human kindness and compassion."

Still, Barnes differentiated between "transposing" and "alternative facts."

"I see it being connected, but not the same," she said in an interview with *The Politic*. "Here people were taking something that had actually happened and twisting it. [But] if a philosopher says something on Facebook, it's not like they're saying it as a philosophy professor. It's just Facebook."

It was not "just Facebook" to Dreher, who published four pieces attacking Stanley: "F—ck You, A—holes, Argued the Yale Professor," "Fun With Paranoid Philosophers," "Jason Stanley Spirals Ever Downward," and "Jason Stanley Epilogue." Stanley has since deleted his Facebook account. He now tweets exclusively links, cautious not to post original thoughts on social media for fear that other users will take them as the professional statements of a Yale professor and not the personal opinions of Jason Stanley.

When asked why he criticized Stanley, Dreher presented himself as a defender of free speech, calling Stanley's comment "a sign of barbarism" that was representative of "the rise of illiberalism in academia."

"What happens at Yale doesn't stay at Yale," he told *The Politic*. "The whole world is watching. And what happens at Yale matters a lot more than what happens at almost any other university because Yale is the training ground for American elites... *Corruptio optimi pessima*, you know [corruption of the best is the worst]."

Dreher went on to connect Stanley's comment to another Yale controversy that went viral almost a year earlier. After Yale's Intercultural Affairs Committee sent an email to students suggesting cultural sensitivity in choosing Halloween costumes, Erika Christakis, an early childhood education lecturer at Yale, sent an email pushing back.

"I wonder, and I am not trying to be provocative: Is there no room anymore for a child or young person to be a little bit obnoxious, a little bit inappropriate or provocative, or, yes, offensive?" she wrote. Christakis' email provoked and energized a wider debate about race at Yale. Students confronted her husband, then-Master of Silliman College Nicholas Christakis, airing their concerns and asking for an apology. Christakis was hosting Greg Lukianoff, the president and CEO of the Foundation for Individual Rights in Education (FIRE), as a guest speaker. Lukianoff filmed the video of the confrontation between students and Christakis. The video went viral.

"The way many Yale professors sided with the social justice warriors over their own colleagues [in Fall 2015], and the way the university capitulated to the mob, was to me a confirmation of Yale's intellectual and moral corruption by identity politics," said Dreher. "Jason Stanley's public behavior in the Swinburne affair was of a piece with this."

Like the anonymous Facebook user who screenshotted Stanley's comment, Lukianoff recorded the events in the Silliman courtyard without the explicit consent of the participants. And like the comment thread, whose privacy settings made it visible only to friends of Abramson, the original poster, the Silliman College courtyard is a semi-private space, enclosed by gates that can only be opened by a Yale ID. Though the Dreher-Stanley debacle attracted far less media attention than the courtyard incident, both boiled down to the same set of issues: free speech and the blurred line between private and public spaces.

Stanley's experience highlights the difficulty of making this distinction.

"Liberalism requires a distinction between the public domain and

"What happens at Yale doesn't stay at Yale," he said. "The whole world is watching. And what happens at Yale matters a lot more than what happens at almost any other university because Yale is the training ground for American elites...*Corruptio optimi pessima*, you know [corruption of the best is the worst]."

the private domain," he said, adding that the ideology asserts the individual's right not only to free speech but also to privacy.

For this reason, Stanley said that he believes it is hypocritical to publicly condemn private sexual practices, as Swinburne did, and to accuse others of illiberalism for private comments, as Dreher did.

In 2015, Stanley coauthored an article titled, "When Free Speech Becomes a Political Weapon," published in *The Chronicle of Higher Education*. He said that he continues to be deeply disturbed by the co-opting of free speech rhetoric by right-wing groups.

The question about public and private spaces is one aspect of a larger debate about free speech taking place on college campuses.

Like Dreher, professor and philosophy blogger Elizabeth Barnes said that she saw larger trends at work in online responses to campus controversies like the Halloween controversy at Yale.

"My suspicion and my impression is that there seems to be a growing tactic on certain right-wing internet news to attempt to target and out and vilify what they take to be radical left-wing professors," she said.

One much-publicized example of this targeting, said Barnes, is *Professor Watchlist*, which keeps a list of professors who "discriminate against conservative students and advance leftist propaganda in the classroom."

Whereas FIRE's mission statement frames the organization's goals in nonpartisan terms—"to defend and sustain individual rights at American colleges and universities" and "protect the unprotected"—*Professor Watchlist* highlights its distinctively right-wing agenda beneath free-speech rhetoric. More broadly, Barnes said, it promotes "the idea that somehow college campuses are indoctrination centers for liberal propaganda."

Online debates and campus controversies are part of a larger conversation about political correctness in the U.S. Terms like "safe spaces" and "free speech" have assumed incendiary connotations.

On its website, *Rightly Considered* sardonically notes, "[We have] a very liberal comment policy. Each commenter speaks for his or herself. Unlike leftists, we believe in free speech and freedom of association." But in an interview with *The Politic*, representatives of *Rightly Considered* downplayed the antagonism in statements like the above, blaming the left for the lack of discourse between left and right leaning blogs.

"We envisioned *Rightly Considered* as the *Fox News* of the philosophy blogosphere...but we have found that our leftist colleagues do not seem at all interested in collegial dialogue," said the representatives. "They would prefer to write us off as racists, bigots, 'neo-Nazis,' etc."

Likewise, Dreher bemoaned the "spirit of chaos and malice [that] reigns at Yale" and warned that "people notice these things."

This barrage of online attacks scared Stanley. He received hate mail and threats, and he worried that the inflammatory blog posts would put his family at risk, given *The American Conservative*'s large readership. Stanley characterized Dreher's series of articles as harassment and his own emotional state as one of "nervous exhaustion."

After he was attacked for his Facebook comment, Stanley weighed the risks of responding and ultimately decided to push back. Kathryn Pogin, a *Feminist Philosophers* blogger and graduate student in philosophy at Northwestern University, published his response on the blog. As expected, the post drew more criticism from right-wing bloggers, including from Dreher.

When I asked Stanley for an interview, we did not meet in his office. Instead, he invited me to an exhibit at the Beinecke Rare Book and Manuscript Library and brought his partner and children along. He later confessed that he wanted to better understand me and my intentions before agreeing to be featured in this article because he had felt misrepresented by other media coverage.

"Whenever you engage with someone who is intentionally misrepresenting you—and I think this was a case of misrepresentation—there's a risk of legitimizing them by responding," said Pogin in an interview with *The Politic*. "[But] conversations that are placed online have a lot of power over how we perceive things—who we take to have control over conversations or who we take to be socially powerful. I think there's a real danger in not responding to people who intentionally misrepresent you."

Reflecting on the events of this fall, Stanley pointed to what he considers to be the central issue.

"It appears that those who are breaking down the domain between the public and the private are, somewhat strangely, doing so by accusing those who defend private spaces of illiberalism," he said. "Up is down and down is up."

The question about public and private spaces is one aspect of a larger debate about free speech, most visibly on college campuses. Like Dreher, Barnes said that she saw larger trends at work in the online response to campus controversies, like the Halloween controversy at Yale. "My suspicion and my impression is that there seems to be a growing tactic on certain right-wing internet news to attempt to target and out and vilify what they take to be radical left-wing professors," she said.

Europe's Vilified Minority: The Roma Through Pictures

BY **MEGAN McQUEEN**

"THE ONLY THING BALKAN PEOPLE AGREE ON IS THEIR HATRED FOR THE ROMA."

Senada Sali works for the European Roma Rights Centre (ERRC), an organization that uses advocacy and strategic litigation to combat discrimination against Roma people. Sali is a Roma woman and a practicing Muslim from Macedonia. Her community once specialized in horse-trading, but today Sali does legal work using her college degree.

The Roma are Central and Eastern Europe's largest ethnic minority. They are also one of its most persecuted. Colloquially referred to as "gypsies" for their supposed Egyptian heritage, the Roma are a heterogenous ethnic group without a single common language, religion, or cultural tradition.

"The Roma don't really work in circuses or magic shows like the stereotype goes," Sali said in an interview with *The Politic*. "Our community is very divided."

Sali explained to me that although she is Roma and Muslim, many other Roma communities belong to different faiths. In addition to religious diversity, Sali said that the languages spoken by Roma communities also vary by region.

In Sali's view, a history fraught with oppression is the only real explanation for modern Roma communities' economic and social disadvantages.

Sali used the example of language to explain how Roma communities throughout the world have been persecuted. "In Spain, they don't speak the Romani language," she said. "The Romani language was banned there, and if you were heard speaking it, you would have your tongue cut off. The Roma there speak a language called Calo instead."

Calo is a blend of Spanish, Portuguese and traditional Romani. It was originally used as a method of discreet communication between Iberian Roma people to avoid being punished by the Spanish authorities. The root of the language's name is the Romani word kalo, which means "black" or "absorbing all light."

"It is called 'black' because of its black history," Sali said.

Many attribute this diversity to policies of forced assimilation in the societies where Roma people settled. Roma communities are vulnerable to discrimination because of their statelessness. Starting in the early 12th century, Roma people began migrating from the region that is now India into the Balkans. The first historically recorded meeting between Europeans and the Roma was documented by an Irish monk who referred to the Roma as "the descendants of Cain," likely for their dark skin.

Throughout the Middle Ages, the Roma were often serfs and slaves in feudal societies. In the 16th century, nomadic Roma communities were expelled from countries like Germany and France. In some other nations they were subject to ethnic cleansing. In an extreme example, Roma women living in Bohemia had their ears severed as a mark of their ethnic identity. Roma were still enslaved in Romania until the late 1800s.

Severe socioeconomic inequalities persist in societies where Roma live today.

"The racist narrative against the Roma necessarily ignores history," Sali argued.

Many Roma settlements have high unemployment, unpaved roads, and unreliable access to health services and running water.

"The stereotype goes that we areimpure, that we do not wash our

Gwendolyn Albert (left) and Martina, a Roma activist (right).

selves. But it is hard to wash yourself when you do not have running water," Sali said. "And it is impossible to get a job if you do not wash yourself."

The Roma's struggles are a stark reminder of continue human rights abuses in Europe. Many suffer from housing discrimination, segregation, police brutality, inadequate access to education and health services, and racial stereotyping.

Instead of addressing these rights violations, many governments in Europe have a paternalistic approach to the Roma.

"One form of social control governments use is taking away Roma children," Sali explained. "They say that Roma families cannot take care of them."

In Central European countries like Hungary, the Czech Republic and Romania, Roma children are often funneled into "special" schools. From the outset, many Roma children receive a low quality education designed for children with learning disabilities. The ERRC has contested this systematic discrimination before the European Court of Human Rights, but to little avail.

Because international courts have few enforcement mechanisms, court rulings in favor of the Roma do not guarantee progress.

"If the political will is not there, then you have to sue," Adam Weiss of the ERRC explained to me. "But even if you sue, change does not happen."

PHOTOS BY **MEGAN McQUEEN** AND **LISA QIAN**

Gwendolyn Albert is an American living in the Czech Republic and a prominent Roma rights advocate. In the eyes of government officials, she explained, justice for the Roma "is seen like something extra."

An education center run by the nonprofit Bagazs in a Roma settlement outside of Budapest, Hungary.

"We provide adult education for people who didn't complete primary school," said Fruzsina Soskuti, a volunteer at Bagazs.

"Because that's often a qualification required for work, or a driver's license."

Scenes from a Roma settlement in a segregated community.

“Do minorities in the United States live like this?” an unidentified man (shown with his son) asked us.

“My parents had to work, and I had to stay home and take care of my siblings,” said Lena, a Roma woman.

“I didn’t finish school.”

“These days, if you want to gain some political points, you can attack the Roma. You don’t help them.”

Stephen from the Open Society Fund, Rayan Alsemeiry ’19 and Lisa Qian ’19.

The Open Society Fund in Bucharest focuses on providing inclusive education for Romanian citizens.

“One third of students diagnosed with mental disabilities in Czechia are Roma children. This is statistically improbable.”

Martin and three other unidentified employees of the Agency for Social Inclusion, which specializes in expanding housing access for the Roma.

“People think the Roma are violent, they rob you, they will harm you, they take advantage of social welfare, and they don’t want to work,” Martin (right) explained.

EDUCATION INTERRUPTED

Expelled and Suspended Students in Connecticut Fall Behind

BY **ADRIANNE OWINGS**

"WHEN TEACHERS DON'T KNOW what to do with unruly students, they sometimes look to the easiest solution they have at hand," Jason Berkenfeld LAW '17 said in an interview with *The Politic*. "Our schools have a problem with how quickly [teachers] turn to severe punishment."

In Connecticut, when students misbehave, many teachers send them home or to in-school suspension. According to a report by Connecticut Voices for Children, a nonprofit organization that promotes the wellbeing of children through research and advocacy, children enrolled in Connecticut schools in 2006 and 2007 missed over a quarter of a million days combined due to out-of-school suspensions.

"The negative impacts of exclusionary discipline on a student are varied," said Alexandra Ricks, an associate policy fellow at Connecticut Voices, in an email to *The Politic*. "We are in favor of laws...that encourage handling any behavioral issues within the school/class when possible."

Educators have long debated how to effectively discipline students. Some teachers prefer traditional methods of demerits and detentions while others prefer positive reinforcement. On the extreme end of discipline are suspension and expulsion, which start as early as preschool and can disrupt a student's education.

"While the traditional approach of suspension and expulsion [gives] teachers an easy out for dealing with difficult students and uncomfortable situations, it [doesn't] help schools fulfill their mission to educate students, help them graduate and become successful adults," said Connecticut Appleseed, a nonprofit that serves low-income residents, in a 2011 statement.

When tension escalates in the classroom, teachers often resort to harsh disciplinary measures. In many cases, these measures can be avoided. Another study by Connecticut Voices found that, in 2011, roughly one in 200 students was arrested for behavioral issues. And at least 11 percent of those arrests were "easily avoidable."

"We have to be doing something wrong if some teachers think that that is their only option," Berkenfeld said.

The problem begins during the preschool years, before children even start formal schooling.

Until a decade ago, practically no research documented expulsions and suspensions in American preschools. But in May 2005, Walter Gilliam, an associate professor in the Yale Child Study Center and of Psychology, as well as the Director of the Zigler Center in Child Development and Social Policy, published a landmark study entitled "Prekindergarteners Left Behind."

"Based on current enrollment rates, an estimated 5,117 prekindergarten students across the nation are expelled each year," said the report. "This rate is 3.2 times higher than the national rate of expulsion for K-12 students."

In an interview with *The Politic*, Gilliam attributed high preschool expulsion rates to the lack of federal laws mandating preschool attendance. There is no due process to protect preschool students from expulsion and suspension, a paucity that results in what Gilliam calls "soft expulsions."

"Soft expulsions occur when a kid has a challenging behavior, leading the school to call the parents earlier and earlier in the day to pick up the kid," Gilliam explained. "For working parents, this means preschool is no longer a viable childcare option anymore, and they eventually withdraw their child from the school altogether, if they're not asked to leave first."

Expulsion in preschool can result from something as simple as restlessness or misunderstanding. If a child is prone to bolting out of the classroom without notice or climbing on furniture, a teacher can classify this child as a "liability" to the safety of everyone in the classroom. Zero-tolerance policies make it even easier to justify extreme disciplinary measures because they allow administrators to immediately expel students who violate school policy, regardless of the specific situation.

For instance, Gilliam recounted a story of one preschool teacher who smelled something suspicious in a three year-old's backpack. She eventually discovered that the boy had brought a stash of marijuana to school, and the student was suspended immediately, even though he didn't even know what he had done wrong.

"The reason for the suspension was not because he was dealing," Gilliam said. "It was because his mother's boyfriend needed to hide the weed from the cops. It didn't change anything."

Similar policies prohibit children from bringing in objects that merely resemble weapons, such as water guns, and force administrators to promptly dismiss a student for having them, even if it is just an accident.

■ **"Those students [affected] tend to be less likely to graduate, have lower academic achievement, and complete fewer years of school."**

The 2005 study found that Connecticut had the seventh highest rate of preschool expulsions and suspensions in the country. Gilliam's work helped produce two potential solutions to the problem: behavioral consultation programs for teachers and legislation that prevents preschools from using disciplinary measures as a tool to manipulate enrollment.

statute adjusted the laws governing these types of discipline to ensure that students would only face out-of-school suspensions if their behavior posed a clear danger to others.

"The [previous] statutes [did] not provide for any flexibility when handling students and allow the school boards to work with the children to find how they should best be punished," said Representative Lawrence F. Cafero Jr., former Minority Leader in the Connecticut House of Representatives, in a public testimony for the 2007 legislation. Cafero gave the example of a student who vandalized a school with racist material being forced to attend an NAACP meeting and write a report on it as punishment.

"The most fundamental question would be—are minority students more problematic? In other words, is their behavior worse? And the data suggests that their behavior is *not* worse."

"Without this prohibitive legislation, they'll just find another way to be choosy in the kids they select for the preschool," Gilliam continued. "If we just have intervention without legislation, no matter how easy we make it to access the consultation programs, it'll still be easier to sit down with the parents and tell them not to come back."

Currently, Connecticut is the only state to have both a consultation program and prohibitive legislation. The state-funded behavioral consultation program began in 2002 and has since expanded. It offers several months of discipline consultation to teachers, free of charge. In 2015, Connecticut's legislature placed a moratorium on out-of-school suspensions and expulsions for students in preschool through grade two.

As students enter middle and upper school, the process for suspension and expulsion is more "legalized," according to Gilliam. A 2007

"Helping the student learn from their mistake by confronting the reason it occurred is better for the student and the community, rather than just removing them from the educational environment for a week," he said.

Not everyone agrees with this approach. Joe Cirasuolo, the Executive Director of the Connecticut Association of Public School Superintendents and former superintendent in both the Clinton and Wallingford school districts, told *The Politic* that the "matter of expulsion and suspension is being handled quite well" by Connecticut schools.

Of all students receiving out-of-school suspensions in 2013, roughly a third were black and another third was Hispanic/Latino, even though these groups comprised only 13 percent and 20 percent of the student population respectively.

Black preschoolers are 3.6 times as likely to receive one or more suspensions relative to white preschoolers.

Boys are three times as likely as girls to be suspended.

Black children only make up 19 percent of enrolled preschoolers, but they represent 47 percent of preschoolers suspended one or more times.

Data from The Yale Child Study Center

"Twice as a building administrator, I took a look at the students who were suspended [on] average for three days, [and] 80 percent were never suspended again," said Cirasuolo. "It was an effective means of discipline."

He also advocated for a mastery-based, student-centered learning approach as a way to prevent the need for extreme discipline in the first place.

"Students who are successfully engaged in learning tend to require less discipline. When [students] engage in learning, they don't misbehave," he said. "They start to own their own learning, and they thrive on it."

Recent evidence seems to align with Cirasuolo's observations. According to a report from the Connecticut State Board of Education, the use of extreme discipline has decreased in Connecticut schools.

The research also found disparities in the use of these disciplinary measures based on factors like race, socioeconomic status, and gender. For example, it revealed that the rate of sanctions against black and Hispanic males was two to three times higher than the rate of sanctions against their white counterparts.

"Our research [at Connecticut Voices] has consistently indicated that exclusionary discipline (expulsions, suspensions, and arrests) disproportionately impacts students of color, low-income students, and special education students," Ricks said.

Evidence also suggests that early childhood suspension and expulsion disproportionately affect males and minority students. Last year, a study from the Yale Child Study Center found that "black preschoolers are 3.6 times as likely to receive one or more suspensions relative to white preschoolers." Even though black children only make up 19 percent of enrolled preschoolers, they represent 47 percent of preschoolers suspended

one or more times. The same study also found that boys are three times as likely as girls to be suspended.

"When these [biases] lead to important decisions regarding how we choose to educate our youngest citizen learners, or deny educational opportunities through preschool expulsions and

suspensions, the potential for lasting harm is great," concluded the report, which was released last year.

Despite the decrease in overall disciplinary measures, Connecticut Voices found that "school arrests, expulsions, in-school suspensions, and out-of-school suspensions all peak in ninth grade." Students' disobedience during this period might simply be attributed to a difficult transition.

Just as in preschool, punishments in higher grade levels disproportionately target minority and low-income students. Of all students receiving out-of-school suspensions in 2013, roughly a third were black and another third were Hispanic/Latino, even though these groups comprised only 13 percent and 20 percent of the student population respectively.

Alan Bruce, an associate professor of sociology and director of the criminal justice program at Quinnipiac University, told the Connecticut Post that it is not a difference in behavior that justifies this imbalance: It's racism.

"The most fundamental question would be—are minority students more problematic?" Bruce said. "In other words, is their behavior worse? And the data suggests that their behavior is not worse."

The ramifications of reactionary discipline are difficult to miss. Early childhood programs provide the necessary academic and social skills many children need to succeed in kindergarten and beyond. Without them, kids can be left playing catch-up well into their elementary years.

"The negative impacts of exclusionary discipline on a student are varied, and those students [affected] tend to be less likely to graduate, have lower academic achievement, and complete fewer years of school," said Ricks.

When students miss out on valuable class time, an achievement gap emerges. A report by the Connecticut Department of Education found that students who had been subjected to out-of-class disciplinary sanctions tended to score lower on the Connecticut Mastery Test and Connecticut Academic Proficiency Test.

Extreme punishment in schools can also contribute to other major issues like mass incarceration and the school-to-prison pipeline. Statistics published by Community Coalition, an organization in South Los Angeles that works to reduce crime and poverty, show that two-thirds of all males in state and federal prison do not have a high school diploma. While Connecticut is slowly making progress to curb these practices, there is still plenty of work to be done.

"Today, we are having conversations about how to address issues such as criminal justice and mass incarceration, but the way we discipline in our schools has a direct link [to these issues]," Berkenfeld said. "We have to get our schools in the right place before we can fix these other problems. There are meaningful changes we could make. We just need to open up the dialogue."

"We have to be doing something wrong if some teachers think that that is their only option."

el

CAN CONTROL

women rush to get IUDs after Trump's election

BY **ANNA BLECH**

AT 11:14 P.M. ON ELECTION NIGHT, Natalie Rose Schwartz '18 was at a watch party with five of her housemates. As North Carolina shifted from blue to red, she started to consider something intensely personal.

"I'm not currently on birth control," Schwartz told *The Politic*, "and am thinking about getting an IUD sooner rather than later."

Schwartz is not alone. Since the election, Planned Parenthood has reported a 900 percent increase in requests for IUDs.

"It's been an unprecedented surge," said Kafi Rouse, the Vice President of Public Relations and Marketing for Planned Parenthood of Southern New England. "There's been a significant increase in our appointments scheduled online for birth control, with demand for IUDs."

IUDs, or Intrauterine Devices, are an increasingly popular form of long-term birth control. Rather than administering daily birth control pills, doctors implant a T-shaped device directly into a woman's uterus. Paraguard, the nonhormonal copper IUD, is effective for ten years, while the four hormonal IUDs available—Mirena, Skyla, Liletta, and Kyleena—are effective for three to five years.

In other words, an IUD will last through the Trump Presidency.

"I've been on the pill for about five years and made an appointment to get an IUD the day after the election," a Yale alumna, who chose to go by the pseudonym Alexa, told *The Politic* in an online correspondence. "Now, with conservatives in control of two (soon to be three, perhaps) branches of government, having long-term birth control felt much less like a convenience and much more like a necessary precaution."

Other women cited cost and the potential loss of insurance coverage as factors in their decision-making.

"I'm currently taking the pill," Rita Wang '19 told *The Politic*. "Right now, I'm covered under my parents' plan for health insurance, which covers my birth control, but if Obamacare is overturned, I would probably not be able to afford having to pay 70 dollars a month for my pill."

IN OTHER WORDS, AN IUD WILL LAST THROUGH THE TRUMP PRESIDENCY.

Before the Affordable Care Act's contraceptive mandate, price was a significant barrier to IUD access, with implantation costing upwards of 1,000 dollars in many states. After the bill passed, everything changed.

"Thanks to the ACA, 20 million people now have healthcare who didn't have it before," Rouse explained. "And the ACA requires almost all health insurance plans to cover all eighteen FDA-approved methods of birth control." Those 18 methods include the copper IUD and at least one brand of hormonal IUD.

Under the Affordable Care Act, most insurance plans are required to cover all preventative care, including birth control, without copay. This distinction is key for patients with high deductible plans that force them to pay out of pocket for the majority of their healthcare expenses.

"What then happens is every time you go to a doctor, you effectively end up paying because you've got this deductible you've got to meet," Sarah Croucher, the Executive Director of NARAL Pro-Choice Connecticut, explained to *The Politic*. "So the way that the ACA is set up, you can go for your annual exam, and you can go to visit your gynecologist, and those things that count as preventative care are free because they are preventative care."

Dr. Neena Qasba, a Family Planning Fellow at Yale New Haven Hospital, said that she supports the contraceptive mandate.

"It's not perfect," she told *The Politic*, "but it did ensure that contraception was covered as a preventative health benefit, and there was no cost sharing. Previously, an IUD would cost hundreds of dollars out of pocket, but under the contraceptive mandate there was no copay. If it [were] repealed, women would be footing the bill again."

The repeal of Obamacare is not an idle threat. Despite the failure of the

American Health Care Act (AHCA), the Republican party has doubled down on its promise to repeal the Affordable Care Act. After the replacement bill was tabled, House Republican Whip Steve Scalise warned Democrats that their "celebration [was] premature."

To the relief of many, the repeal of Obamacare would not have guaranteed the repeal of the contraceptive mandate. In order to avoid a filibuster from the Democrats, Republicans framed the AHCA as a Budget Reconciliation Bill, which would only have required a simple majority in the Senate. Therefore, the Republican plan could only change those parts of the Affordable Care Act that are related to federal funds, most importantly the individual mandate and the Medicaid expansion. The contraceptive mandate does not fall into this category, since it does not involve the allocation of federal funds.

But others have pointed out a more chilling reason the Republican plan failed to repeal the contraceptive mandate: it didn't have to.

Dr. Nora Niedzielski-Eichner LAW '18 is a board member of "Yale Law Students for Reproductive Justice," a group at Yale Law School that does research pertaining to reproductive care access. "When they pass big statutes like [the Affordable Care Act], they leave a lot of the details for the government agencies to figure out," she told *The Politic*.

Those details usually come in the form of agency regulations, which are much easier to change than a Congressional statute. Altering them, however, still requires "notice and comment," a procedure in which the proposed regulation is made available to the general public. The entire process can take months.

Statutes typically leave details to regulations, but the Affordable Care Act left details out of both the statute and the regulations. Instead, the law deferred the essential part of the contraceptive mandate, that "all Food and Drug Administration approved contraceptive methods" must be covered as preventative care, exclusively to the guidelines of the Department of Health and Human Services.

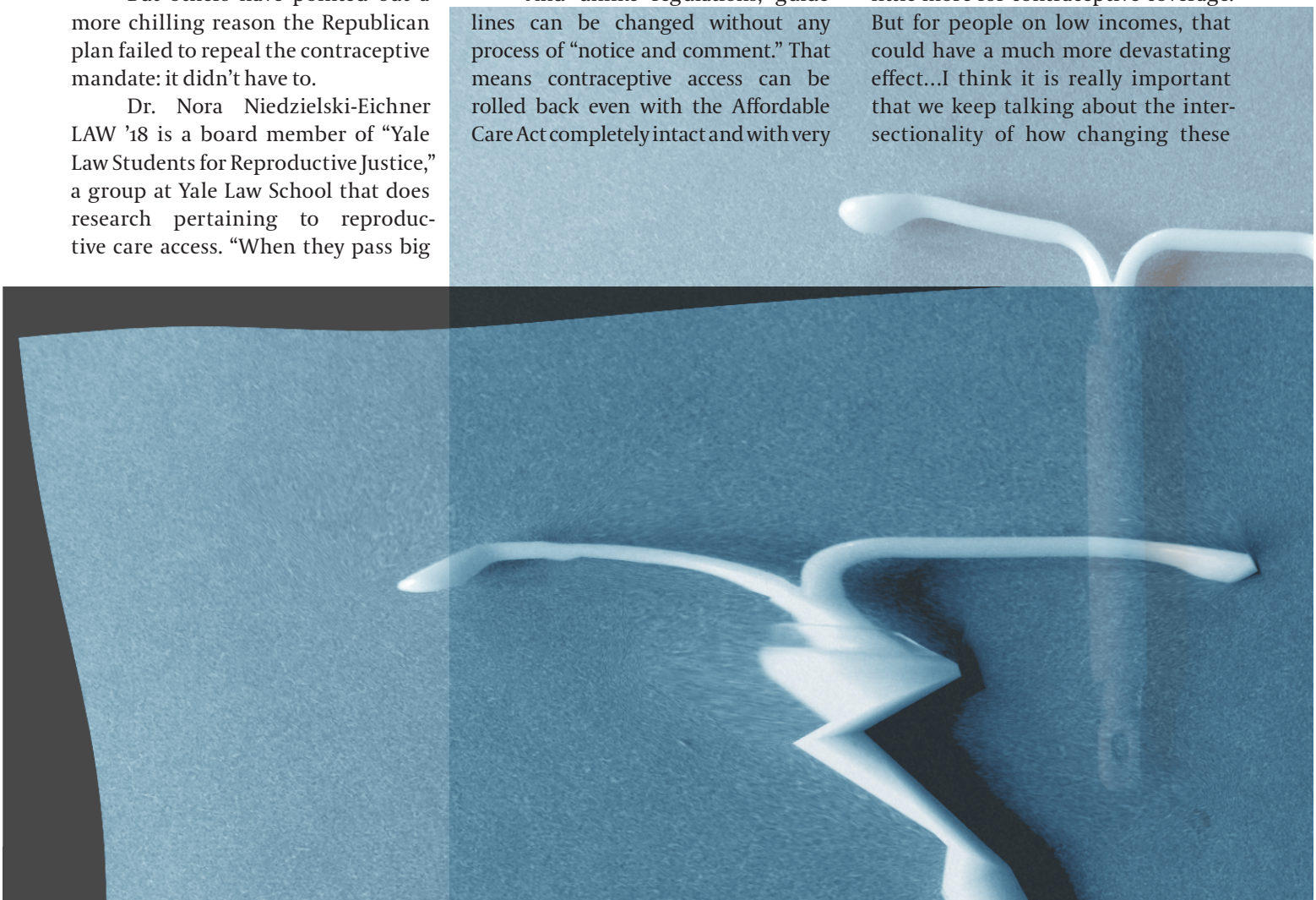
And unlike regulations, guidelines can be changed without any process of "notice and comment." That means contraceptive access can be rolled back even with the Affordable Care Act completely intact and with very little opportunity for public pushback.

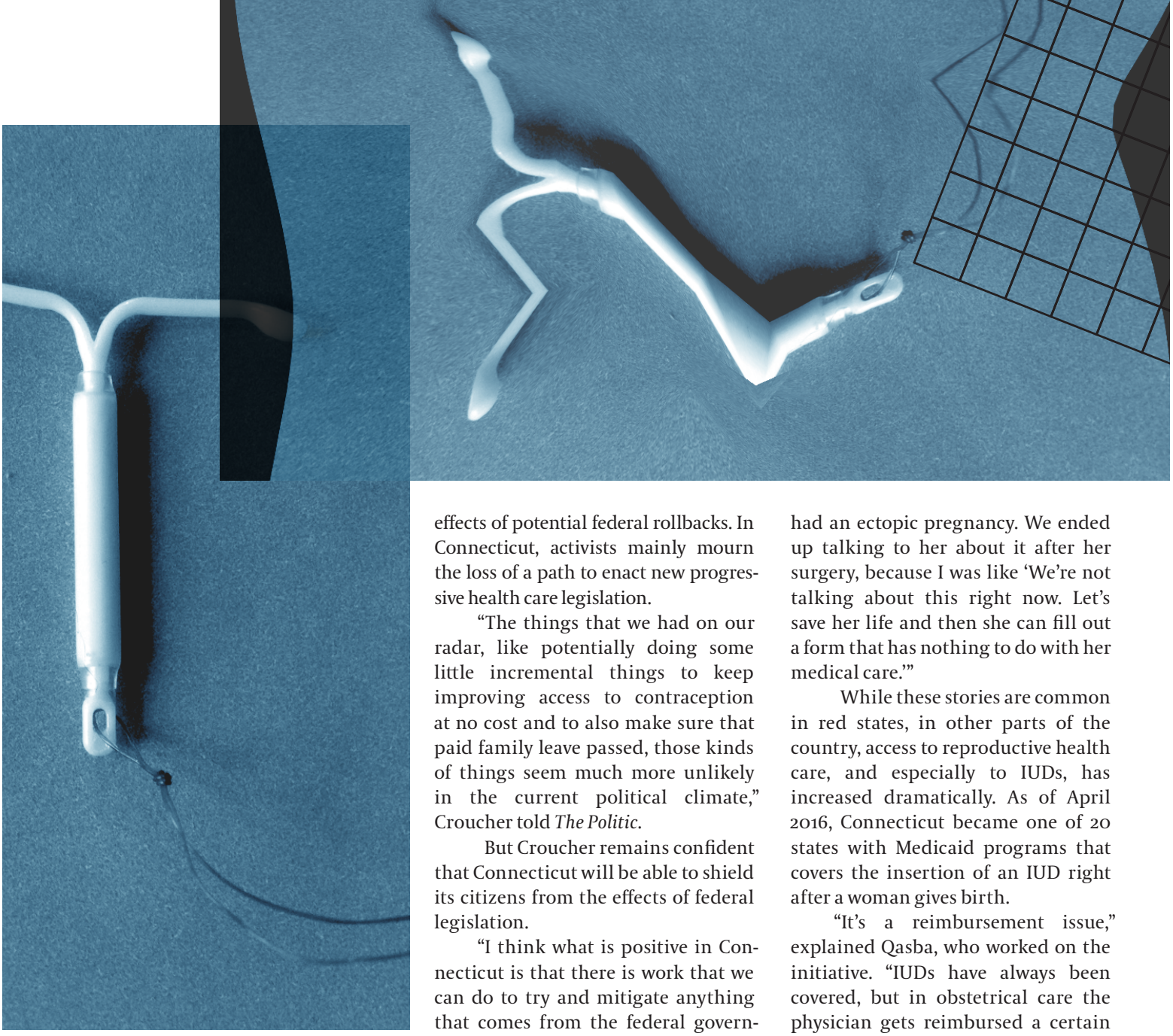
"I am very angry about the fact that the Obama Administration did not put contraceptives into regulations and left them in guidelines," Niedzielski-Eichner told *The Politic*. "Women's preventative health care is too important to be treated as if it could be taken away without any review process or public input."

"It's low-hanging fruit," Croucher said of the contraceptive mandate. "If they have to say that they have done something, and they need little bits of things to chip away at, that's one of the things that they can chip away at pretty early on."

Chipping away at the contraceptive mandate would not affect all women equally.

"It means different things to different people," Croucher told *The Politic*. "For someone like me, it means that I am going to end up paying a little more for contraceptive coverage. But for people on low incomes, that could have a much more devastating effect…I think it is really important that we keep talking about the intersectionality of how changing these





policies is going to continue to keep people in poverty and to make life much harder for them."

The disparity applies not just to access to birth control but to all reproductive health care.

Rollbacks in abortion access, Rouse explained, would also have a "disproportionate impact on those who are already facing far too many barriers to healthcare, such as people of color and people who live in rural areas, and people with low incomes."

The impact of the new administration's agenda will also be unequal across state lines.

In blue states, reproductive rights advocates are optimistic that state governments will be able to blunt the effects of potential federal rollbacks. In Connecticut, activists mainly mourn the loss of a path to enact new progressive health care legislation.

"The things that we had on our radar, like potentially doing some little incremental things to keep improving access to contraception at no cost and to also make sure that paid family leave passed, those kinds of things seem much more unlikely in the current political climate," Croucher told *The Politic*.

But Croucher remains confident that Connecticut will be able to shield its citizens from the effects of federal legislation.

"I think what is positive in Connecticut is that there is work that we can do to try and mitigate anything that comes from the federal government and to make sure that we don't lose access and go backwards in terms of women's health," Croucher continued. "I don't think that in Connecticut we are going to let people lose access to vital contraceptive services. But I think that that's a very different case in other states."

Dr. Qasba hails from one such state. During Qasba's residency at Indiana University, then-Governor Mike Pence signed a bill requiring doctors to discuss with women who had just miscarried the option of burying the fetus.

"I was rolling [a patient] back to the ER and she's bleeding and they're like 'You have to make her sign this form about burying her pregnancy tissue,'" Qasba said. "She had an ectopic pregnancy. We ended up talking to her about it after her surgery, because I was like 'We're not talking about this right now. Let's save her life and then she can fill out a form that has nothing to do with her medical care.'"

While these stories are common in red states, in other parts of the country, access to reproductive health care, and especially to IUDs, has increased dramatically. As of April 2016, Connecticut became one of 20 states with Medicaid programs that covers the insertion of an IUD right after a woman gives birth.

"It's a reimbursement issue," explained Qasba, who worked on the initiative. "IUDs have always been covered, but in obstetrical care the physician gets reimbursed a certain amount for a vaginal delivery and a certain amount for a C-section. You couldn't get extra things added on."

Now, with a new billing code specifically designed for postpartum insertion of IUDs, women can get long acting birth control inserted immediately after delivering a baby. In the past, new mothers had to wait six weeks to discuss birth control at a postnatal visit.

For many women, that visit never happened.

"We know that women, especially those who are low resource have difficulty with transportation or social support," said Qasba. "They are frequently unable to return for their postpartum visit where most of the contraception initiation occurs

after pregnancy. If you can put in the IUD right after [childbirth] it promotes birth spacing and decreases unplanned pregnancy."

Pregnancy is also the time when women are most likely to be insured, since many states use Medicaid to temporarily insure pregnant women who would not otherwise qualify.

But the increasing number of insurance-insecure women getting IUDs raises concerns about follow-up care and removal.

"I got the IUD this past August," a full-time mom from North Carolina, who had purchased insurance through the Affordable Care Act healthcare exchange, told *The Politic*. "I had UnitedHealthcare, but last month my payment got raised to 400 dollars a month so now I don't have insurance." She told *The Politic* her doctor would charge her 400 dollars out of pocket to have her IUD removed, a price she couldn't afford.

"Having the availability of IUDs and implants is very exciting but unfortunately, as we are going into uncertainty of coverage in the future, we need to make sure that patients have the resources to get them out when they want them," Qasba told *The Politic*. "Otherwise it could become a coercive practice to give women these devices and not have the resources for them to get them out when they want to."

Women who fall into the Medicaid gap are particularly vulnerable. The Affordable Care Act planned to insure people in two distinct ways. First, the bill required states to expand Medicaid to cover all people with incomes lower than 138 percent of the Federal Poverty Line (FPL) or risk losing Medicaid funding. Then, those making 100 percent to 400 percent FPL were given subsidies to purchase private plans on health care exchanges. But even as the Supreme Court upheld the constitutionality of the individual mandate in a five to four vote, it ruled seven to two that the federal government could not force states to expand Medicaid.

As a result, 19 states have refused to accept the Medicaid expansion. Because they are mostly red states skeptical of government spending, they are also the states that previously had the most limited Medicaid coverage. The Medicaid gap is made up of the people in those states who make too much money to qualify for Medicaid, but not enough to qualify for subsidies on the healthcare exchanges.

"In those states that don't have a Medicaid expansion, you just have this gap of people that aren't on subsidized private insurance and can't afford any kind of private insurance," Croucher explained. "The whole idea of the ACA was that you expanded Medicaid so that you had people covered by Medicaid up to a certain point, and then they started to get subsidies to go into private insurance."

In other words, it is now possible to be too poor to qualify for health care subsidies.

Connecticut accepted the Affordable Care Act's Medicaid expansion and does not have a Medicaid gap. But Qasba emphasized that care should be taken to protect the health care access of other vulnerable populations.

"We have a sizeable community of undocumented immigrants and when they want IUDs, that is one of the things we talk about with them, about what are their options to get them out," she told *The Politic*. "No woman should feel trapped with her device that she doesn't want anymore."

WHAT DOES IT MEAN FOR WOMEN TO MAKE MEDICAL CHOICES FOR POLITICAL REASONS?

What does it mean for women to make medical choices for political reasons?

"I think that there are good reasons why people might not want to have a baby in the next four years," Croucher said. "I know some who are feeling doom and gloom about the idea of potentially bringing a child into the world in the Trump years, and then there are those people who are worried about having their health insurance continue to fund [their] birth control."

"I've been thinking about getting an IUD for years, but put it off because I've been concerned about negative side effects that might come with changing my birth control method," Alexa told *The Politic*. "It was never a priority, just an option that occasionally crossed my mind. After the election results came in, I jumped into action around the IUD because it felt like something I could control."

"We have had patients who have gotten an IUD last year," said Rouse, "and they called back just this month to say 'Can I go ahead and get another one so that the clock will start all over?' The Presidency is four years."

SOUTH AFRICAN STUDENTS FIGHT FOR HIGHER EDUCATION

BY **SETH HERSCHKOWITZ**

CHAIRS FLEW THROUGH THE AIR as student protesters tried to shut down the Higher Education National Convention in Johannesburg, South Africa. Singing turned to chanting and pushing as protesters rushed towards the stage. The students were protesting the keynote speaker, South Africa's education minister, Blade Nzimande. As the protest became violent, Nzimande was ushered away and the event was canceled.

"What is [Nzimande] going to say? He's not going to say anything we want to hear," one protester said.

The protest was one of many demonstrations throughout South Africa condemning the government's failure to carry out effective education reform. United under the hashtag #FeesMustFall, students across the country have spent the last several years protesting the steady rise of public university fees.

The struggle gained mainstream attention after student demonstrations broke out at the University of Witwatersrand (Wits) in 2015. The school's administration announced that fees for the next school year would increase by 10.5 percent, a major change intensely opposed by students. In response to protests surrounding the fee hike, South African President Jacob Zuma implemented a temporary freeze of all public university fees for the following academic year; universities were barred from raising school fees.

Despite the freeze, protests have continued.

"University fees [were] high way before the increase," explained Mduduzi Makgata, a first year student at the University of Pretoria studying for a commerce degree, in an online correspondence with *The Politic*. "The fee freeze had zero effect."

"The increase in University fees is like adding petrol to a fire," Makgata continued. His fees for university total around 100,000 Rand (7,296 dollars) per year—more than his entire family makes.

Luckily, Makgata received a large loan from the National Student Financial Aid Scheme (NSFAS) which allows him to attend school. But keeping up with fees can pose daily challenges.

"Fees are so high. The NSFAS can't cover it all. I still owe the university residence a lot of money and they keep sending me emails and sms's reminding me that I could get kicked out any moment which makes it difficult to focus on studying," Makgata explained.

Current tensions surrounding school fees trace back to the early 1900s, when South Africa established its national education system. The original collection of South African universities contained schools that were all-white, all-black, or racially integrated. Some universities taught only in Afrikaans and aimed to educate the white Afrikaner elite. There were also universities that focused on educating black students. Other elite universities, like the University of Cape Town (UCT), instructed in English and were racially integrated.

"The idea was that anyone who had gone through the requisite secondary training could register and take courses [at integrated universities]," said Yale South African history professor Daniel Magaziner in an interview with *The Politic*. "In actuality, very few [black] Africans were able to."

When the Apartheid government rose to power in 1948, even these few opportunities disappeared—all universities were segregated.

"UCT, Wits, all of these universities that had had this nominal black student body become whole white universities," explained Magaziner. "[The government] creates a whole series of new universities for Africans that are divided by ethnicity and are located in the Bantustans, which are these fictive colonies that the Apartheid government created in order to create this illusion that there was one white South Africa and then

"If kids see that they're never going to be able to afford university, it impacts their commitment to education."

-Richard Kelley

there were ten smaller ethnically delimited polemical spaces."

The already small percentage of black students enrolled in university before Apartheid dropped dramatically with the election of an all-white government. In 1974, despite making up more than 80 percent of the population, black Africans comprised 0.1 percent of the enrolled university population within South Africa.

After the election of Nelson Mandela and the end of Apartheid in 1994, the South African government worked to reintegrate the higher education system. The new leadership pushed elite universities reserved for white students, such as the University of Cape Town, to admit African students.

"The white universities [resisted]," said Magaziner. "What [resulted] is a university system that is very much bifurcated between elite all-white universities that begin to integrate and then these very poor underfunded universities in the Bantustans that still exist that are brought under the national system of higher education."

Former Bantustan universities, which remain under-resourced and undesirable to white privileged youth, have become a primary destination of higher education for black students.

"They remain 99-100 percent black and it's in those universities where fees must fall begins before the hashtag," Magaziner continued.

However, for many South African youth, the very prospect of attending university remains far out of reach. Within Mamelodi, the second largest township in South Africa, lavish homes and a large university campus share the street with small shacks. Low-income citizens in Mamelodi are lucky if they receive access to basic educational needs.

Makgata recognizes that his university education is a rare privilege for black South African students.

"I'm very grateful," he reflected. "We [black students] have been struggling to get into university. Most of our brothers and sisters dropped out, some couldn't even get in, not because of academics but because of financial constraints."

Because of the structural challenges facing all levels of South African education, activists like Richard Kelley, the founder and director of the Mamelodi Initiative, have remained removed from the #FeesMustFall movement. In Mamelodi, there are still basic needs that are not being met.

"If you're a nonprofit, you're focused on primary school access or water access, things on a much more basic level," Kelley told *The Politic*.

The Initiative works in Mamelodi to provide students with access to educational resources through collaborative leadership councils, after-school programs, and computer literacy initiatives. Their work focuses on the primary and secondary students as they prepare to apply to college.

Kelley said that improving higher education starts at the primary school level.

"Unfortunately, it's still a pretty big privilege to go to university from Mamelodi. South Africa does have a lot of work still to do on making sure that there's access to education for everyone," said Kelley. "Part of that is going to be figuring out this fee hike crisis. But it's also just as much about figuring out how you get good education at every level."

The fight for more affordable universities does not end at lowering tuition costs. Beyond the rising fees exists an entire education system in peril.

"What is being obscured by this attention paid to universities is that the South African education system—from primary school through secondary school to the matriculation exams which allows you to go to university—is in crisis," explained Magaziner.

The entire South African education system is fraught with obstacles. At the primary and secondary education levels, township schools are under-resourced and do not typically provide students with the education they need to succeed. Most scholarships are based on academic success, which places many low-income township students in a bind.

"If only you could step into a Grade 12 Maths classroom in any high school in Mamelodi or any township, you would understand why it is so difficult to get high marks," said Makgata.

Students who manage to make it through secondary school must take the National Senior Certificate matriculation exam, or Matric. Matric is a series of standardized tests that determine to which colleges students are eligible to apply. Failing the Matric bars students from enrolling in university. The fail rate is remarkably high, especially considering the

"No one has any faith that even if [the government] were to tax more, that the ANC government under Zuma would actually spend it wisely. These are people who systematically pillage government revenues."

-Daniel Magaziner,
Yale Professor of S. African History

stakes: 23.8 percent of students failed the Matric in 2016. That translates to around 190,400 high school students.

Financial aid also remains inaccessible. Many students, like Makgata, receive loans from the government that leave them in deep debt by the time they graduate. The National Student Financial Aid Scheme provided 186,150 students with loans in 2014. Some third-party organizations distribute bursaries, and the government also offers tuition subsidies for specific areas of study, like agriculture. Even if students are given financial aid, however, they might not receive enough money—or not receive it in time.

"Often, loans or bursaries are distributed late, which means that students aren't able to then pay for their fees or for their books until into the semester," said Kelley.

It is common for students to become eligible for private scholarships only once they are several years into their studies.

"One of the big challenges is that usually your first year, you may not have a bursary or a scholarship," said Kelley.

"Sometimes you are able to gain [a scholarship] as you go, from companies that you will work for as long as you promise to work for them afterwards. So one of the biggest gaps is surviving that first and possibly second year in university until you have a spot from a company," Kelley continued. With costs quickly rising, paying full fees for that first and second year is often impossible.

These barriers to attaining college degrees create a culture of apathy at the primary and secondary school levels.

"If kids see that they're never going to be able to afford university, it impacts their commitment to education," said Kelley.

This sense of hopelessness similarly discourages South Africans from pursuing jobs in education.

"If you don't have individuals who are going off to education or kids who are walking away with a lot more debt, the likelihood that they're going to come teach in a township school is impacted," he said.

Fees affect universities just as much as they affect students. Universities in South Africa predominantly run on fees. If the fees stop rising, universities stop running. Though government funding for public universities has increased by around 70 percent over the past 15 years, student enrollment has also increased dramatically. The government hasn't been able to keep up.

"If fees don't rise, then those universities actually have a very hard time functioning," said Magaziner. "The year of the [fee] freeze put a real burden on the universities to try and maintain their excellence while also dealing with the fact that students can't afford to pay fees. If you want to keep the university structure, they will argue—even people who are very sympathetic to [students]—if you want Wits or UCT to remain a truly elite global universities, you can't stop raising fees."

"This is what you do. You disrupt in the face of perceived injustice."

-Daniel Magaziner

An alternative to raising fees is raising taxes. But the African National Congress (ANC), the party of Mandela and current majority party in government, has been known to mishandle government funds, a practice that has led to public mistrust. A growing movement in South Africa is calling for the resignation of the current president, Jacob Zuma. This movement is united under the banner "Zuma Must Fall." The first South African president without a university degree, Zuma used 16 million dollars in government funds to renovate his private home in 2009–funds that could have gone to subsidizing public education.

"No one has any faith that even if [the government] were to tax more, that the ANC government under Zuma would actually spend it wisely. These are people who systematically pillage government revenues," said Magaziner.

Still, the #FeesMustFall movement has received considerable backlash for the violence perpetrated by some of its members. Last October, #FeesMustFall protests caused nearly 50 dollars million worth of damage. With the media focusing on the more violent wings of #FeesMustFall, some people in South Africa are asking whether these protests are doing more harm than good.

"I think to conflate an approach to everyone's approach is often oversimplifying. I think that protest movements are not always as unified as we would like them to be seen," said Kelley.

While many #FeesMustFall protests are peaceful, not every part of the movement has agreed on a single method.

"People have found or feel that the only way their voice is ever heard is if they create some sort of damage or stop something from going. Some students are feeling that the only way to get heard is by causing something that requires an address," Kelley continued.

These criticisms are not unique to #FeesMustFall.

"People were asking those same questions about the protests that shut down the various workings of the government under apartheid," said Magaziner. "When people would protest, when they would burn things, when they would register their discontent, people would say: 'Look at this amount of damage. Is this more harm than good?' This is the grammar of South protests. This is what you do. You disrupt in the face of perceived injustice."

Despite political, historical, and socioeconomic barriers to reforming the South African education system, students like Makgata remain hopeful.

"If more people could realize that this is not about just students, it's about the country as a whole," he said, "and if the whole country joined, fees will surely fall."

AFTERPULSE

BY **PETER ROTHPLETZ**

PHOTOS BY **PETER ROTHPLETZ**

The Gay Rights Movement in an Age of Uncertainty

CHRISTINE LEINONEN CALLED her son, Drew, in the early evening of June 11. She knew that he and his longtime boyfriend, Juan, had spent the hot Florida Saturday at Seaworld. Drew told his mother about about the theme park's new rollercoaster, reflected on how watching the movie *Blackfish* made the excursion a tad bittersweet, and discussed a few logistics for her upcoming surgery. Drew had insisted on being his mother's "right hand man" for the procedure, a promise that was not at all out of character. The call lasted about 20 minutes; Drew and Juan were tired, and they still had to drive home and prepare for a small pool party the next day. Recalling the night in an interview with *The Politic*, Christine said she ended the check-in the way she always did, by saying "I love you." Drew responded as he always did: "I love you too, Mom."

Early the next morning—at 2:02 A.M. according to an FBI timeline—the Orlando Police Department got word that multiple shots had been fired at a nightclub. Reportedly, an off-duty officer, who happened to be on the premises, exchanged fire with an armed assailant. At 2:08 A.M. officers deployed to the scene entered the building. One minute later, a warning was posted to the club's Facebook page: "Everyone get out of Pulse and keep running."

Drew and Juan were among the 49 people who could not escape. The couple had decided, late Saturday, to serve as "wingmen" for a mutual friend who was anxious about an upcoming date. Drew and Juan were sitting at a small table near the dance

floor when the shooter entered the nightclub. Christine would not learn of her son's death until late Sunday after waiting nearly 12 hours inside a local hospital.

ON THE OTHER SIDE OF THE country, I was Ubering home from a restaurant in West Hollywood. The California primary had just ended, Clinton had secured her nomination, and my schedule as a campaign reporter had been granted a few free days to enjoy the Golden State. About halfway through the ride, an AP alert flashed onto my cell phone. I didn't sleep that night—I packed a change of clothes into an athletic bag and bought a ticket to Orlando.

Some time later, I found myself in the corner booth of a Subway Restaurant on South Orange Avenue. My t-shirt was soaked, as were my pants, boots, and camera bags. Violent thunderstorms had rattled through Orlando, forcing the city's visitors to take shelter anywhere they could. Around me, the large, burly bodies of video technicians were packed tightly against airbrushed on-air talking heads. Producers, junior producers and assistant junior producers sat together in compact herds, glued to their laptops and Android phones. The few seats left open were retooled into makeshift docks for gangly wifi routers.

And yet, despite the bizarre chaos of the scene, the room was silent—gripped by a mixture of anxiety and grief. Every few minutes an Orlando resident or two would walk through the Subway's glass doors—either to escape the rain or buy lunch. For a split second, they would gawk at the sight before them, pause, and then they too would slide into the quiet sobriety. I sat across from CNN's Jim Sciutto and a young female producer. They would whisper back and forth every now and then, wearily exchanging notes and contact information across a table half covered by untouched sandwiches.

The massacre, its victims, and its survivors dominated the news cycle for the last two weeks of June. The press seemed to take over Orlando. Fat Winnebago RVs plastered with three-letter logos lined the closed-off streets that surrounded the nightclub. On-air talent was flown in from across the country, and live reports from the scene ran every few minutes on cable channels.

Headlines varied but stuck to similar themes. The event was labeled the deadliest single-gunman mass shooting in U.S. history, the deadliest incident of violence against sexual minorities in U.S. history, and the deadliest terrorist attack committed on U.S. soil since September 11.

DONALD TRUMP, THEN STILL IN THE midst of a race for the White House, was quick to issue his thoughts on Twitter early Sunday morning:

@realDonaldTrump, 8:07 A.M.: "Really bad shooting in Orlando. Police investigating possible terrorism. Many people dead and wounded."

Several more tweets followed, including:

@realDonaldTrump, 1:58 P.M.: "Is President Obama going to finally

"We had to bring another lawsuit because the state of Florida would not issue death certificaates to same sex couples."

"Even today all queer people have a calculus in the back of their heads when they go to show affection in public. They think they may get called a name. They think they might get beat up. They think they might get murdered [...] There is a long history of violence against us."

mention the words radical Islamic terrorism? If he doesn't he should immediately resign in disgrace!"

@realDonaldTrump, 4:47 P.M.: "What happened in Orlando is just the beginning. Our leadership is weak and ineffective. I called it and asked for the ban. Must be tough."

One statement, however, ignited a considerable degree of controversy:

@realDonaldTrump, 12:43 P.M.: "Appreciate the congrats for being right on radical Islamic terrorism, I don't want congrats, I want toughness & vigilance. We must be smart!"

The tweets, in many ways, epitomized Trump's larger campaign effort—brash, provocative, and ostensibly unscripted. Some, like Joseph Murray, an openly gay contributor to Breitbart News and the Orlando Sentinel, lauded the remarks: "There are a lot of populist politicians that will say a lot of things to get elected; I don't think that's the case with Donald Trump."

In an interview with *The Politic*, Murray said that he thought Trump's response wasn't just appropriate—it transformed the dynamic of the presidential race: "[The shooting at Pulse] enabled Trump to change the dialogue and do something that no Republican candidate has ever done, which was take up the LGBT mantle, but do it a way that isn't an "us versus them" in terms of social conservative Christians versus the gay community but more like LGBT and all Americans versus this radical threat that comes from abroad."

But others took offense at the GOP nominee's reaction. "Trump tried to use Pulse to his political advantage. His tactics are about instilling fear in people. Using the Pulse tragedy to do that was despicable," Russell Roybal, Deputy Executive Director of the National LGBTQ Task Force, told *The Politic*. "Trump's strategy to attack and scapegoat Muslims was wrong and is wrong."

BY WEDNESDAY JUNE 15, THE media frenzy around the carnage had attracted a host of alt-right figures to Orlando. Milo Yiannopoulos, then a Breitbart editor, and Gavin McInnes, a conservative commentator, held an impromptu press conference a block from Pulse. The setup was simple: The pair stood on a street corner about 500 feet from the main media camp. About a dozen cameras were lured out to film the spectacle.

Against the backdrop of a rainbow flag and some half a dozen teenagers donning red "Make America Great Again" hats, Yiannopoulos railed against U.S. immigration practices, gun free zones, and the political left. The speech lasted about 30 minutes, but the self-proclaimed "provocateur" made sure to close by applauding "one of the presidential candidates" and his idea to "protect homosexuals" by preventing Muslims from entering the country.

Despite Yiannopoulos' stamp of approval of Trump's response to Pulse, the proposed travel ban was blasted by both sides of the political aisle. Democrats and Republicans alike labeled it xenophobic and un-American. Even so, a groundswell of voter turnout and the electoral college carried the real estate tycoon into the White House five months later. The outcome caught many by surprise, but it served as a particular shock to activists like Roybal who anticipated at least four additional years of left-leaning leadership in Washington.

Now, nearly ten months after the Pulse shooting and with a Republican president, LGBT advocates find themselves in a new era of uncertainty.

"There was a time a year ago when we were making progress and were headed in the right direction. Now I think the fear is that the progress is coming to a halt, and we're going to have to fight with every ounce of being that we have just to try to retain what we had achieved up to this point," Mary Meeks told *The Politic*. She works as an Orlando-based civil rights attorney who served as co-counsel on the Florida marriage equality lawsuit (*Pareto v. Ruvin*) that struck down the state's same-sex marriage ban.

When asked to point out the specific issues currently being litigated across the country, Meeks and Roybal highlighted nearly all the same theaters of conflict: antidiscrimination protections in employment, housing, and public accommodations, religious freedom legislation, and state initiatives around the country to pass laws similar to North Carolina's House Bill 2, also called "Bathroom Bills."

While many battles are being fought in state court houses and legislatures, Roybal expressed equal concern over rhetoric and policies coming from the White House: "I think [Trump] is an opponent to LGBT equality. I think during the campaign he talked a good game, but his and Vice President Pence's administration is set up to be the most anti-LGBT in our nation's history."

Roybal noted that Pence supports conversion therapy. "[Pence] believes that LGBT people can be cured," he said.

"I don't think this administration is any friend to LGBT people," he continued. "In fact, some of the actions they've already taken like pulling back guidance for school districts on trans students is just the first in a series of things that we will see from them attacking our community."

Even in early June, there was anxiety over what a Trump presidency could mean for sexual minorities. When I covered a massive candlelight vigil convened in Los Angeles for the victims of the Pulse shooting, Lorri L. Jean, chief executive of the LA LGBT center, even went so far as to assert that the attack was not provoked by radical terrorist groups abroad but was a product of "divisive" figures in the U.S.—namely, Texas Lt. Governor Dan Patrick and Trump. The assertion, made before a crowd of more than 2,000, was met with significant applause.

Chadwick Moore, a contributing writer to *The New York Times, OUT Magazine, Playboy,* and *The Advocate*, said that he believes this fear of the president is overblown. "Trump was the first and only presidential candidate to take office supporting gay marriage," Moore told *The Politic*.

Many took note when, as president-elect, Trump stated he was "fine with" same-sex marriage during an interview with *60 Minutes* last November. Trump went on to declare the issue is "irrelevant" and "done."

Trump's proponents also point out he was the first Republican nominee for president to include sexual minorities in his convention speech. In July, he told the Cleveland crowd, "As president, I will do everything in my power to protect LGBTQ citizens from the violence and oppression of a hateful foreign ideology." Then, reportedly, Trump went off-script: "I have to say, as a Republican, it is so nice to hear you cheering for what I just said."

The remark (and the response it received) was particularly stunning considering how only five years prior, at a September GOP primary debate on *Fox News*, boos erupted from the Republican audience after a gay soldier, then serving in Iraq, posed a question regarding "Don't Ask/Don't Tell" and the role of sexual minorities in the U.S. military.

"You'll never get a majority of the LGBT community to say they love Donald Trump, but what Trump did was weaken the presence of social conservatives in the Republican party," Murray explained. "[Trump] did so because we're in a post-marriage equality world. In a post-marriage equality world, the losers aren't relevant anymore."

Referencing incidents of bakeries refusing to cater gay weddings, he continued, "Some might say now it's the cupcake wars—well look, you can fight all you want over cupcakes and wedding cakes. But when you have people tossed off of rooftops half a world away, that's a lot more pressing."

THE PULSE NIGHTCLUB SHOOTING and Trump's election seem to share one aspect: Both led Americans to question whether the culture war over homosexuality and gay rights was over. Many people staunchly believe that the day the Supreme Court ruled same-sex marriage to be the law of the land, in *Obergefell v. Hodges*, LGBT equality had been fully realized. Others saw it as only a step on a path to justice. To some, like Murray, the most significant ongoing challenges largely exist abroad. People of that view point to the threat that radical extremist groups like ISIS pose to sexual minorities in the U.S. and eerie reports of Chechen police officers kidnapping and murdering gay men. But Meeks and Roybal believe there is far more work to be done at home.

Meeks is still working on the ground for LGBT rights in Florida, not too far from Pulse nightclub, even after the Supreme Court ruling. "We had clerk officers here like [Kim Davis in Kentucky] who refused to serve gay couples. We had to actually file another lawsuit against the state because they would not issue birth certificates to same-sex couples in compliance with the Florida statute. We had to bring another lawsuit because the state of Florida would not issue death certificates to same-sex couples," she said.

"Even in the realm of so called 'marriage equality' those rulings

"Some of the young men spent their last living moments on a cell phone talking to their mothers. Compare that to the nightclub massacre in [New Orleans] where many of the bodies were never even claimed by family members. They wanted nothing to do with their gay sons."

barely got us halfway to the practical realization of that equality," she reflected.

Roybal also pushed back against the notion that the U.S. is as LGBT-friendly as some public opinion polls suggest. "Even today all queer people have a calculus in the back of their heads when they go to show affection in public. They think they may get called a name. They think they might get beat up. They think they may get murdered," he said."There is a long history of violence against us."

Jim Downs, a Harvard University Fellow and associate professor of history at Connecticut College, has researched violence against sexual minorities in the U.S. extensively. In an interview with *The Politic*, Downs explained, "Before Orlando, the worst instance of anti-gay violence was in New Orleans." In the 1973 mass murder, 32 patrons of a gay bar burned to death after an unknown attacker doused the club's only entrance with lighter fluid. Similar cases occurred throughout the 1970s, as arsonists targeted LGBT churches and speakeasies.

During an interview with *The Politic*, Maria Trumpler, Director of Yale's Office for LGBTQ Resources, also acknowledged many of the troubling episodes that sexual minorities have faced. But she argued that considering the public outpouring of sympathy and grief after the Pulse attack, it is hard not to acknowledge how far America has come. "Some of the young men spent their last living moments on a cell phone talking to their mothers. On the one hand that's horrific, on the other hand that's absolutely fascinating…even though they were out gay men at a gay club…they had close familial relationships."

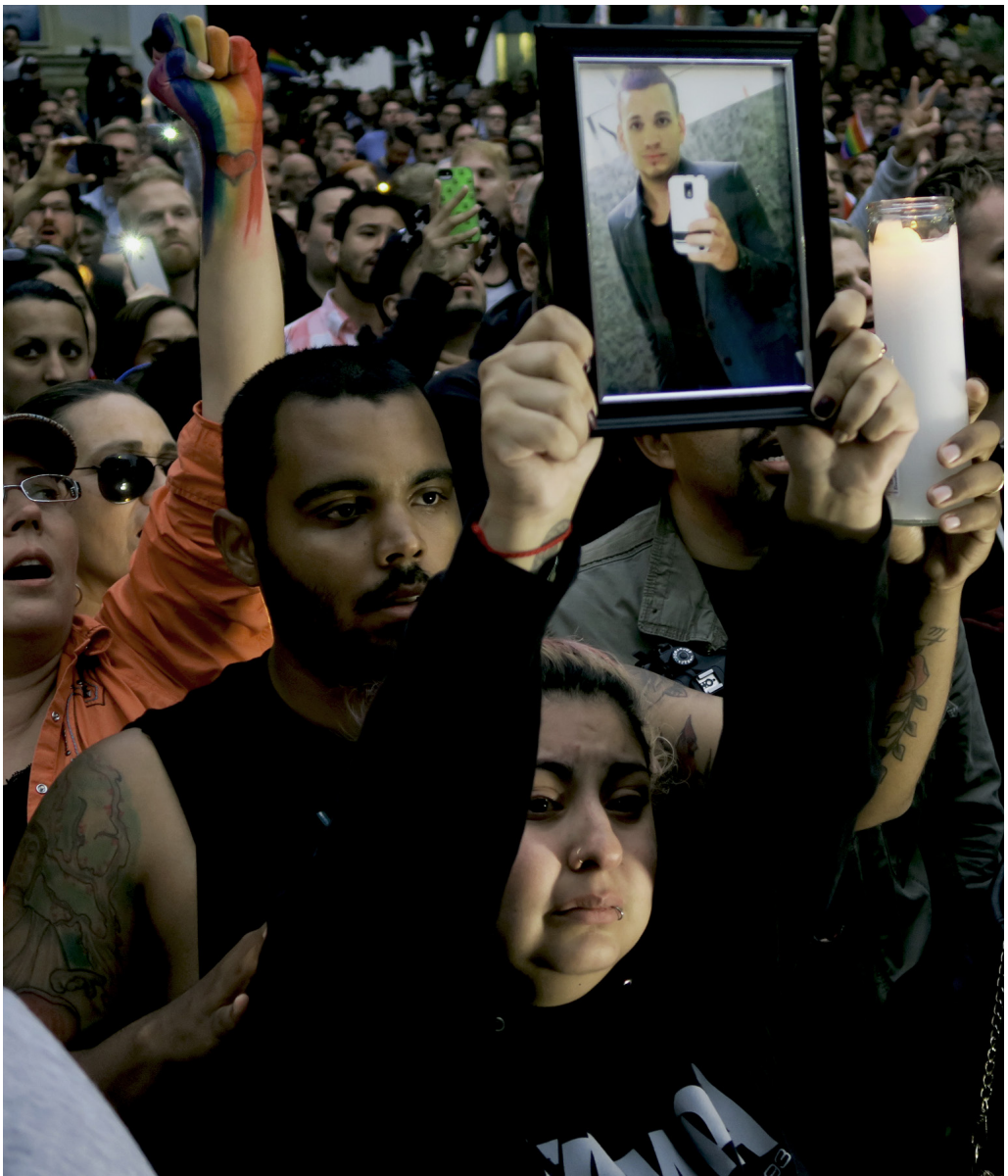
She continued, "Compare that to the nightclub massacre in [New Orleans] where many of the bodies were never even claimed by family members. They wanted nothing to do with their gay sons."

SEVERAL MONTHS INTO THE TRUMP administration, the future of LGBT rights is unclear. Legislative battles will continue across the country. Clear civil rights victories like *Obergefell v. Hodges* are not as final as one might imagine. And despite significant gains in America's acceptance of sexual minorities, years of data on anti-LGBT violence along with stark case studies like Orlando cement the fact that it is still unsafe to be queer in the U.S. According to the National Coalition of Anti-Violence Programs, 20 to 25 percent of lesbian and gay Americans will be the victim of a hate crime in their lifetimes.

Nearly ten months after the Pulse massacre, the surrounding community is still rebuilding. Valentina Guerrero '19, an Orlando native, told *The Politic* that her hometown has not yet recovered, and she doubts if it ever will. No mural or memorial can salvage all that was lost.

But the community has rallied all the same. Thousands of people flocked to blood banks after Pulse—700 reportedly lined up to donate at just one of the facilities in Orlando. "That image has power," Guerrero said. Meeks watched city officials—Republican and Democrat—address enormous vigils across the state. And millions of Americans stood in solidarity with Christine Leinonen when she appeared on television to describe losing Drew—her openly and unapologetically gay son.

"Pulse doesn't have a silver lining. I know it will emerge, though. The hero Christopher needed didn't surface in time… but everyday Americans can choose to have zero tolerance for hatred and bigotry. They can give Christopher's story and the Pulse story that silver lining."



"Make Europe G

Outsider Schulz revitalizes German politics

BY **ERIC BRAEUNER**

ANGELA MERKEL MIGHT BE the most powerful woman in the world. A preacher's daughter who was raised in Communist East Germany, Merkel has been Chancellor of Germany for eleven years. Until recently, she seemed well-positioned to win a fourth term in her country's national election on September 24, 2017.

Merkel now faces the first serious challenge to her control of the highest political office in Germany. And while right-wing groups are gaining popularity across Europe, including in Germany's southern neighbors Austria and Switzerland, this threat comes from the opposite side of the political spectrum.

Martin Schulz is the former President of the European Parliament, the European Union's directly-elected legislature. Without spending even a day serving in the German Parliament, the *Bundestag*, he has now launched his campaign to topple the reign of *Mutti*, a nickname for Merkel that means "Mother" in German.

Labeled a Socialist version of Donald Trump, Schulz appeals to Germans who feel excluded from his country's generally successful economy. In contrast to Merkel, who holds a PhD in physical chemistry, Schulz did not finish high school. Rather than attending university, he trained as a bookseller and ran a bookshop for several years.

"[Schulz] presents himself as one of the common people," Matthias Moehl, an analyst for the German political website election.de, told *The Politic*.

Schulz is the Chairman of the Social Democratic Party (SPD) of Germany, which was barely competitive with Merkel's Christian Democratic Union/Christian Social Union (CDU/CSU) in the last two elections. He has since revived the Socialist Party, which, despite its prominence throughout its 150-year-long history, now occupies a junior role in the coalition led by Merkel.

A candidate with no national political experience might expect to stand little chance against a seasoned leader. But as Donald Trump's victory proved, lack of experience is no longer an insurmountable political barrier. In fact, it might bolster the SPD's chances in the upcoming *Bundestagswahl*, the German federal election.

The emergence of the political outsider Schulz injects energy into the SPD, a once-lethargic party. With Schulz at the helm, the SPD is more likely to oust Merkel than it was under the leadership of well-established politicians like Peer Steinbrück and Frank-Walter Steinmeier. Schulz is not truly anti-establishment, given his position in the European Parliament. But his lack of *Bundestag* credentials combined with his leftist platform and personal background is enough to make many Germans see him as the alternative to Merkel's regime.

Schulz speaks publicly about his struggle with alcoholism. For those frustrated with Germany's path but unwilling to support the extremes of (The Left) or the right-wing populist *Alternative für Deutschland* (AfD), he is a very relatable figure. He is building the coalition he needs to provide a viable center-left alternative to Merkel and the CDU/CSU.

"[Schulz] was…not on the radar of the media and the people in the last twenty years," Moehl said. This adds a fresh, exciting dimension uncommon in a leader of a major German political party, especially when compared to Merkel and her long tenure as chancellor.

The media calls his surprising popularity the "Schulz Effect." It has contributed to rapid gains for the SPD in pre-election polls. Two recent surveys found the CDU/CSU and SPD in a dead heat heading into the summer campaigning season.

According to Moehl's analysis of recent polls, "Martin Schulz is a reason for many of the SPD voters to vote for the SPD."

The attention surrounding Schulz launched the SPD into the spotlight, but the party's long-term outlook remains uncertain. Any momentum that Schulz and the SPD have now, whether from the Schulz Effect or from general discontent with Merkel's chancellorship, will have to continue until the election in September. Moehl doubts the excitement will last.

"His program right now is Martin Schulz, and nothing else," said Moehl.

Results from a March election in the western state of Saarland, Schulz's first test as federal party leader, were poor for Schulz's party. The SPD was comfortably bested by Merkel's CDU, 41 percent to 30 percent, despite previous polls predicting a tight race. If this result reflects broader unease with the SPD across Germany, the party's chances in September do not look promising.

To Moehl, this disappointment demonstrates that the Schulz Effect "doesn't really carry the SPD too far."

"If people are more or less content with how things are, there is a good chance that they will keep the chancellor who is in power…regardless of person or party," said Moehl.

This incumbency advantage is likely the biggest obstacle Schulz would need to overcome in the chancellor's race. While American politicians frequently campaign on a platform of change, Moehl argued that German politics is fundamentally different.

"Germans don't like change that much," he said.

Tiemo Woelken, a member of the European Parliament (MEP) and a member of Schulz's SPD, disagreed.

"Merkel has sought to maintain political power without clear discussions on where she stands," said Woelken in an interview with *The Politic*. "This works for a certain amount of time, and the past elections have shown that this works for a long time. But in a time where there's always more questions, like what Germany's position is in Europe, or the relationship between Germany and the U.S., or the migrant pol-

icy, the people want clearer answers. Merkel has not provided these."

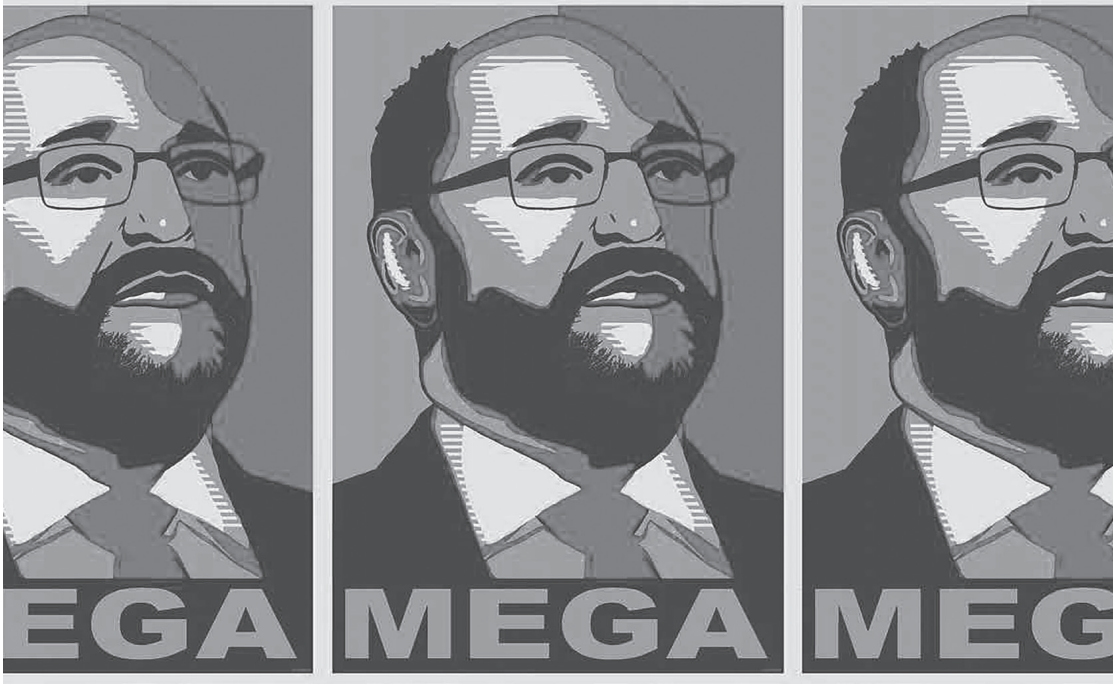
Schulz presents a viable alternative to Merkel. Thomas Kleine-Brockhoff, Vice-President and Executive Director of the think tank German Marshall Fund of the United States, analyzed Schulz's candidacy in an interview with *The Politic*.

"With Schulz, Germans got choice; now they have the choice between two serious candidates. The question is whether they want choice or whether they want change," Thomas Kleine-Brockhoff explained. "Choice they've got, change they can get, but it's unclear whether they do want it."

Schulz will continue his campaign in the remaining state elections of 2017 before the national elections take place. Elections this May in the northwestern state of North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany's most populous state, will be an important test for Schulz's SPD.

"State elections always have a limited meaning, although you'd have to say North Rhine-Westphalia is one of the two or three of the sixteen states that play on the national stage, and North Rhine-Westphalia does play that role as a bellwether state. It did play that role in previous elections, because it is contested, and it has a psychological effect," said Kleine-Brockhoff.

As the important state election approaches, Schulz's campaign can count on strong support on social media. Using MEGA ("Make Europe Great Again") as a satirical play on Donald Trump's campaign slogan and a subreddit called "r/the_Schulz" mirroring Trump's "r/the_donald," Schulz supporters are rallying support for the passionate campaign fight.



With MEGA ("Make Europe Great Again") as their satirical play on Donald Trump's campaign slogan, and a subreddit called "r/the_Schulz" mirroring Trump's "r/the_donald," Schulz supporters are readying have geared up for a passionate campaign fight.

With a meme to match every Trump meme, whether it be "High Energy" changed to "Hohe Energie" or "No Brakes" changed to "Keine Bremsen," online supporters are using the phrases that helped launch Trump into office to get their anti-Trump into the *Bundeskanzleramt*. Both the mainstream German media and Schulz himself have recognized Redditors' contributions to the campaign.

Supporters view Schulz as a return to an older, more left-wing SPD, as opposed to the party's recent centrist approach.

"SPD partisans are being reminded of another Social Democrat, Gerhard Schröder—later chancellor of this country—who one time in his ca-

"SPD partisans are being reminde
country—who one time w

reer, when the capital was still Bonn, was looking from the outside into the grounds of the chancellery, and he was hanging onto the fence and rattling the fence saying 'I want in here,'" said Kleine-Brockhoff.

Even if it does not win an absolute majority in the *Bundestag*, the SPD could find itself at the helm of Germany's next government. A coalition with left-wing *Bündnis 90/Die Grünen* (The Greens) and the liberal *Freie Demokratische Partei* (FDP), feasible given their ideological proximity, would send Merkel out of office. Another option entails the SPD continuing its present coalition with the CDU/CSU, except with Schulz in charge instead of Merkel. But any chance at a Schulz chancellery in such a coalition would likely require his party to poll higher than Merkel's.

Schulz and the SPD have resonated with millions of German voters by resisting the trend across Europe towards right-wing populism. AfD, the largest right-wing party in Germany, is polling at around ten percent for the upcoming *Bundestagswahl*, though it has had better results in some recent state elections.

"It looks like the AfD is losing support, and they might even fail to clear the five percent threshold necessary to get seats in the parliament," Moehl said.

After Brexit and the rise of Euroscepticism across the continent, many moderates see a vote for Schulz as a vote for the European Union. An SPD victory would be a final blow to any talk of a potential AfD-supported "Gexit."

Given the long-standing German distrust of right-wing populism after World War II, Schulz is likely to attract many voters who are disaffected with Merkel's policies but unwilling to vote for a more extreme party.

"Martin Schulz is not a part of the current government and has been involved with European politics rather than German national politics," said Woelken. "Schulz is therefore disconnected from the current Merkel coalition government, which has lost touch with the voters."

While he acknowledged that it is nearly impossible to predict September's results this far out, Woelken said that he thinks Schulz has a good shot.

"I think that Martin Schulz, as a candidate for the SPD in the *Bundestag*swahl, actually has a good chance to take the chancellery, and we're seeing that in the polls," he said. "Now we're seeing the poll numbers stabilize, with more people voting SPD with Martin Schulz as the candidate. The people have told the SPD that this choice of a candidate was correct."

With five months remaining until the election, it seems that any potential SPD takeover of the *Bundestag* will come at the heels of the Schulz Effect. Even without a final victory, Martin Schulz will have brought the SPD much-needed momentum.

"The Schulz Effect has mobilized the party. People within the party structure are excited that there is actually somebody who is ambitious, who is not shy about saying what he wants, which is the chancellery," Kleine-Brockhoff said.

The last time the SPD was in control, Europe was only a few years into the Eurozone experiment. There was no refugee crisis, no debt crisis, and little debate on whether countries would remain in the European Union at all. Now, 12 years later, it might be Schulz's opportunity to prove that he and the SPD can run a global powerhouse.

ed of another Social Democrat, Gerhard Schröder—later chancellor of this was hanging onto the fence and rattling the fence saying 'I want in here.'"

WHOSE LONG ISLAND? IMMIGRANTS IN SUBURBAN NEW YORK

BY **SANOJA BHAUMIK**

ON NOVEMBER 8, 2008, SEVEN white teenage men in Patchogue, New York decided to "hunt down Mexicans." Throughout the evening, they attacked Hispanic men in their small Long Island town. By the next morning, Marcelo Lucero, a 37-year old immigrant from Ecuador, was dead.

Last year, Donald Trump attended a fundraiser organized by the Suffolk County Republicans at the Emporium Night Club in Patchogue, just down the street from the gas station where Lucero died. Protesters lined the streets with anti-Trump posters and slogans. Joselo Lucero, Marcelo's brother, spoke tearfully at the site of his brother's death.

In the eight years between these events, Long Island immigrants had won small victories. They elected friendlier politicians, organized against hate crimes, and benefitted from national immigration policies such as Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (DACA). But Donald Trump's November 2016 election has reopened old wounds.

Long Island, made up of Nassau and Suffolk counties, has long been perceived as a white, affluent suburb of New York City. Demographic shifts, however, have forced some to reconsider this characterization. Since 1980, the Hispanic population has tripled to 330,000 people, or 12 percent of the total population. Overall, 500,000 immigrants live in Long Island, making up 17 percent of the total population.

Salvadorans, who arrived in large numbers in the 1980s during the Salvadoran Civil War, make up the largest foreign-born group. The community grew enough to demand the establishment of Long Island Consulate location in 1998. Located in Brentwood, Suffolk County, it is the only foreign consulate in either county. The Consulate provides legal, social, and cultural services to the thousands of Salvadoran nationals living in Brentwood.

On any weekday, Salvadorans fill the Consulate building, waiting in line for legal advice and passport services. People sit in trucks parked outside, playing music and eating Salvadoran delicacies, like pupusa. The building has transformed into a quasi-community center, serving as a safe space for many residents.

"At least 50 percent of Salvadorans living in Brentwood are undocumented," said Miguel Sevillano, the Consul General of the El Salvadoran Consulate of Long Island, in an interview with *The Politic*. The Consulate's establishment and subsequent expansion occurred in response to community demands, and today it facilitates communication between immigrants and local government.

Nonprofit organizations have also grown over time to serve immigrants. Community members in Nassau County established the Central American Refugee Center (CARECEN) in the early 1980s to provide legal support to the large number of arriving Salvadorans. Today, CARECEN serves immigrants from any country who reside in Long Island.

"The population and its needs have shifted, and CARECEN's services evolve with those needs," said Elise Damas, a CARECEN lawyer, in an interview with *The Politic*. Today, CARECEN operates in Brentwood and in Hempstead, a town in Nassau County. Both towns have attracted Hispanic immigrants and become centers for pro-immigrant community organizations. Along with CARECEN, organizations such as Make the Road NY (MRNY) and New York Communities for Change (NYCC) have offices in these towns, providing direct services and organizing political action.

Immigrant groups have sustained efforts against Long Island's anti-immigrant politics. The Suffolk County Executive at the time of Lucero's death, Steve Levy, was a notorious nativist who drew on local xenophobia for support. As Executive, Levy supported violent immigration raids in the county and attempted to deputize county police officers as federal immigration agents. Responding to accusations that his rhetoric fueled the Lucero murder, Levy distanced himself from the killers. In a press conference, he framed the acts not as "a question of any county policy or legislation", but rather "bad people doing horrific things." After facing years of organized opposition from the immigrant community, Levy lost a reelection bid to Democrat Steve Bellone in 2011.

BATTLE FOR RIGHTS IN

Nevertheless, "Long Island remains fundamentally Republican," said Consul Sevillano. The facts support this claim. Ed Mangano, the Nassau County Executive, is an avid Trump supporter. Seven out of Long Island's nine State Senators are Republicans. The majority of Long Island's 13 towns have Republican-controlled Town Councils and a Republican town supervisor.

"In a lot of minds, Long Island is still a place for rich, white people," Angel Reyes, an organizer at Long Island Immigrant Students Advocates (LIISA), told *The Politic*. Reyes criticized the characterization of New York as a blue, progressive, pro-immigrant state.

"We're constantly fighting with a Republican-controlled county, a Republican-controlled State Senate," Reyes said. He cited the unsuccessful New York Dream Act of 2016, which would have opened up financial aid to undocumented students in the state. According to Reyes, the bill failed in the Senate after receiving two opposing votes from Long Island State Senators.

At the town and county level, immigrant advocates lobby for access to public services, action against hate crimes, and better treatment by the police. In many ways, local governments ignore the needs of their immigrant residents. In the Town of Islip, for example, which houses Brentwood, Hispanic residents make up 20 percent of the total population. The town's website, which contains forms for building permits, leases, codes, and other regulations, has no information available in Spanish.

Immigrant students also face barriers to quality public education. Long Island is nationally recognized for its high-performing public school districts, but only 3 percent of Hispanic students in the region have access to these schools. Unequal education is not new; a recent report from the Civil Rights Project at UCLA lists Long Island as one of the most segregated regions in the country. Due to restrictive zoning policy and the lack of affordable housing, Hispanic immigrants tend to cluster in areas with failing school districts.

65 percent of Hispanic immigrants in Nassau County live in the Town of Hempstead, which also has one of the worst performing high schools in New York State. The neighboring town, Garden City, has a 93 percent white population and the 18th best school district in the state. With the arrival of thousands of young immigrants from Central America, schooling issues intensified.

According to Lauris Wren, Director of the Asylum Clinic at the Hofstra University School of Law, "In the summer of 2014, Long Island was one of the top destinations nationally for unaccompanied youth travelling from Central America." In an interview with *The Politic*, Wren explained that the Youth Advocacy Clinic at Hofstra helped young asylum-seekers stay in the country.

In fall 2014, the Hempstead Union Free School District came under fire for violating federal law and denying enrollment to dozens of recently-arrived students. The New York Civil Liberties Union (NYCLU) and NYCC filed a joint-complaint to the State Attorney General, and the district was forced to open an annex to accommodate new students. The incident publicized the poor-quality education and lack of funding that plague districts with large immigrant populations.

Local officials also have control over one of the most contentious issues for Long Island immigrants: policing. Angel Reyes of LIISA described

the vulnerability of the undocumented population, which must confront both an increase in hate crimes and fear of the police.

"Both Nassau and Suffolk County police collaborate with ICE (Immigration and Customs Enforcement)," said Reyes. In December 2016, Suffolk County reversed part of its "sanctuary" status. County Sheriff Vincent DeMarco announced that the police would no longer require a judge's order before detaining immigrants wanted by ICE for deportation.

Wren argued that such policies endanger all residents. "It causes immigrants to not cooperate with the police and not seek protection from the police, which in turn has a negative impact on the entire community," she told *The Politic*.

Consul Sevillano echoed these concerns. In Brentwood, serious and fatal gang violence has led to increased police surveillance and deportations. As of March 2017, thirteen MS-13 gang members had been arrested for the murder of two Brentwood teenagers. Disputes between MS-13, a U.S.-based gang started by El Salvadoran nationals in Los Angeles, and the Blood, Crips, and Salvadorans with Pride, has elicited fear in the Brentwood community. Sevillano suggested that deportations and arrests were not the only solutions to the violence.

"It's a matter of insufficient resources for the youth. They need opportunities here," he said. In addition, he argued that deportations alone were ineffective, as many deported individuals continue gang activities in El Salvador. The uptick in gang violence coincided with the presidential campaign, potentially fueling U.S.-born resident fears of a dangerous immigrant influx. As Sevillano pointed out, however, the majority of gang violence victims have been either immigrants or their children.

Immigrant organizations and supporters have been fighting for policing and educational changes for years, but the new state of national politics has intensified the battle.

"Since the election, there has been a great deal of fear," Elise Damas told *The Politic*.

SINCE THE ELECTION, THER GREAT DEAL OF FEAR

RE HAS BEEN A

Damas heads the Pathway to Citizenship program at CARECEN, which provides free citizenship assistance to the 100,000 lawful permanent residents in Long Island who are eligible for naturalization. By early 2017, Pathway to Citizenship had assisted over 2000 clients.

"This year was unprecedented," said Damas, recounting the dramatic increase in clientele. "When people came into our office, 25-year residents, we asked them: 'Why now?' And they said: 'Because Trump.'"

A desire to vote and protect vulnerable family members pushed many permanent residents to complete citizenship applications. In November 2016, Trump carried Long Island by 20,000. Now that Trump has ascended into the presidency, immigrants face uphill policy battles along with the daily reality of living in a Pro-Trump area.

"My greatest fear is the creation of an environment that is so blatantly anti-immigrant," said Damas. "This has emboldened segments of our communities that had up until now been lurking in the shadows."

Angel Reyes, himself a Peruvian immigrant and DACA recipient, described his personal concerns for the upcoming years. "We're afraid of losing our status. Thousands of us go to high school and college here. We are business-owners. I've lived here for 15 years." Although Reyes has been fighting for Latino immigrant justice for several years, he cited the present sentiment as exceptionally frightening.

The consequences of the Trump election have began to take shape. After the inauguration, a wave of federal raids in New York led many immigrant fears to be realized. In an April 2017 panel at Long Island University, Laura Lemus of Long Island Wins Magazine described a case in Brentwood.

"A father of three was detained inside of his house in front of his children. The ICE officers had entered the back of his house without permission and they detained him and continued with deportation proceedings because he had a DUI from over two years ago," Lemus told the audience at the event.

Organizations have allied to oppose raids and other anti-immigrant policies. Make the Road NY, for example, has coordinated several protests, rallies, and events across the region in response to Trump policies. Damas and Wren also emphasized the power of forming coalitions to offer greatest support to immigrants.

Alliances extend beyond immigrant-centered organizations. In January 2017, Reyes planned a Town Hall for Unity at a Nassau County church, which included participation from local Black Lives Matter organizers, Jewish groups, Muslim leaders, and many others. In the most diverse event he had ever organized, Reyes hoped to strengthen ties between groups targeted during the presidential campaign.

Until local officials take a stronger stand, these organizations must balance quick responses to daily crises with long-term policy goals. However, Reyes stressed the need for all Long Island voters to oppose harmful state and national government actions.

"Ultimately, we need to send a message to others in the community to act."

FROM THE CAMPAIGN TO THE CLASSROOM:

Yale's Resident Politicians Balance Bias

BY **SARAH STROBER**

"AFTER MY ACTIVE POLITICAL CAREER WAS OVER, I decided that instead of trying to transform many lives a little bit, I would try and transform a few lives a lot," said Former Vermont Governor Howard Dean '71 in an interview with *The Politic*. A 2004 Democratic presidential candidate, Dean began teaching at Yale eight years ago, and has since taught a variety of courses, most recently "The Politics of Foreign Policy."

Yale has become a popular destination for politicians after their time in the public sphere. Former Secretary of State John Kerry '66 recently announced that he would start the Kerry Initiative. Next year, he will teach an undergraduate seminar and hold a speaker series.

"Teaching, researching, convening, engaging, and collaborating with young people and together wrestling with the world's most complex issues is an exciting chapter in the journey that began for me in New Haven," Kerry told YaleNews.

John DeStefano, who served as mayor of New Haven from 1994 to 2014, pointed to similar reasons for choosing to teach at Yale after his political career.

"It kept me engaged with young people in an exchange of ideas and occasional argument that I found interesting and engaging intellectually," DeStefano said. He now teaches a political science course called "Making Public Choices in New Haven."

DeStefano hopes his years in politics can help him guide students about "what works and what doesn't," not "in terms of policy substance but in terms of how you build effective relationships and judgements."

The opportunity to take classes taught by professors with real-world experience is attractive to many students at Yale interested in government.

"All else equal, I would prefer a professor with professional experience because exposure to the non-academic world broadens and enhances the instructor's perspective," said Will Field '20 in an interview with *The Politic*. He said that he believes professionals-turned-teachers "are more attuned to the applications of their knowledge and therefore more dynamic in their approach to teaching."

Nolan Phillips '18 agreed.

"Howard Dean solidified my interest in U.S. politics," said Phillips, who took "The Politics of Foreign Policy" in the fall of 2016. "The fact that he has experience in politics made our discussions often center on current political issues that were related to the weekly readings but not entirely centered on analyzing the text. There was definitely a more applied, real-life angle to the discussions."

Both Dean and DeStefano acknowledge that though they bring biases into the classroom as Democratic politicians, they try to be transparent and welcome dissent from students.

"I'm not neutral about anything," Dean said. "The most important thing is not to pretend you don't have a bias, but to understand that you do and what it is and what other people's biases are, so that biases can become part of the discussion," he continued.

DeStefano has a similar approach.

He said that he consciously chooses to "acknowledge to the class that everything, from the very selection of the topic we are going to discuss to the readings that were assigned to the self-evident role that I played in those things, represents a point of view."

"The most important thing is not to pretend you don't have a bias, but to understand that you do and what it is and what other people's biases are, so that [they] can become part of the discussion."
- Howard Dean

DeStefano said that he believes his experience making compromises as the longest-serving mayor of New Haven helps him see more than one perspective in the classroom.

"The best way I try to engage the class around the substance of [difficult decisions] is to first acknowledge [differing opinions] and second to reinforce the idea that ultimately these are the kinds of issues and concerns that they are going to intellectually have to work through in terms of their own life experience and views," he said.

Phillips said that he believes Dean successfully brought personal politics into the discussion in a balanced way.

"Howard Dean is clear about his political positions, but I never felt this added any sort of bias to the discussion. If he ever made a remark that someone disagreed with, we were very welcome to bring up our own counterpoints," said Phillips.

But Dean and DeStefano might be in the minority in encouraging dissent. *The Politic* spoke to several Yale students who said that many of their professors this year had brought their political beliefs into the classroom without explicitly acknowledging their own political bias or welcoming differing opinions.

Many students told *The Politic* that they have observed more professors discussing politics since the 2016 presidential election. These discussions occurred in classrooms across departments, not just the political science classes where they might be most relevant to the course material.

"Yale professors are very, very progressive, lying on the left of the political spectrum," Grant Richardson '18 told *The Politic*. "My professors usually do not explicitly bring their politics into class discussion, instead implicitly conveying their dissatisfaction with the Trump administration."

Still, Alex Weyerhaeuser '20 does not feel that her professors' partisan opinions hinder her classroom experience.

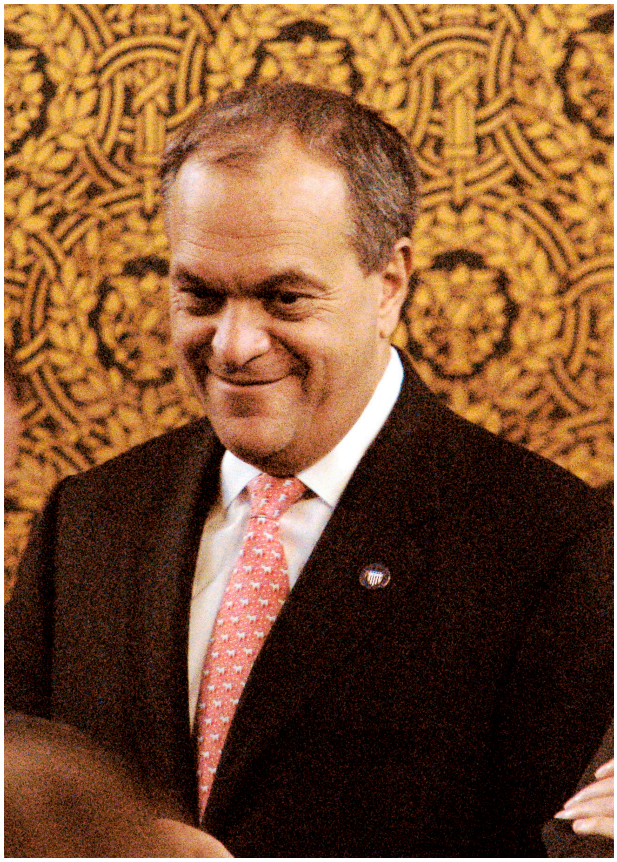
"I've never been uncomfortable about [professors bringing up politics] and I've never felt like it has dominated the classroom at all. That being said, I definitely feel like I do know what their political beliefs are and I'm okay with that because I agree with them," said Weyerhaeuser.

Nevertheless, she added, "I can't speak to what it would be like for a super conservative person or a Trump supporter to be in one of these classes and hear these comments because it doesn't apply to me."

Esteban Elizondo '18 said that he welcomes debate in the classroom.

"If anything, classes should be ideologically hostile," he told *The Politic*. His criticism

Howard Dean '71, Former Governor of Vermont, has taught at Yale for eight years.



John DeStefano, former Mayor of New Haven, is now an appointed lecturer at Yale.

"I have actually turned in papers that I fundamentally disagree with because the ones with my actual opinions received poor marks."

was not that professors expressed personal political opinions but that they did not try to "push both sides of the argument."

Once in a class on the Iraq War, Elizondo said, "the discussions essentially turned into consensus."

DeStefano said that he does not believe classroom conversations should be one-sided.

"Part of what the classroom experience should be about is to develop skills and techniques to engage disagreement without being disagreeable...I think there is a default position to be polite and sometimes not engage," said DeStefano. "However, I think the best way to [overcome biases] is generally to openly acknowledge [them]."

There are not many conservative students at Yale to bring a different perspective. Only 12 percent of Yale students identified as "conservative" or "very-conservative" in an October 2016 poll done by the *Yale Daily News*. Of that percentage, 95 percent said that their opinions are not respected in the Yale community. In comparison, more than 98 percent of all respondents said liberal views are welcome.

"Given that few professors share my conservative political views, voicing a conservative opinion in discussion or in a paper entails a certain degree of risk to one's grade or reputation that many conservatives are not willing to take," said Richardson.

Beyond impacting class discussion, the liberal bent of professors can also affect students' work.

"I have actually turned in papers that I fundamentally disagree with because the ones with my actual opinions received poor marks," Elizondo said. "It's always a bit demoralizing to hear 'how far' I have come in a class with a professor when the only progress I have made is repeating what the professor says in class on my paper."

Both Dean and DeStefano had careers as strong advocates for only one side. But they emphasized that while having biases is not a problem, failing to acknowledge them is.

"The biases that are the biggest problem are the ones you either don't know about or more likely, actively work to suppress. Those are the biases that people don't want to talk about and those are the ones that I try to get at," said Dean.

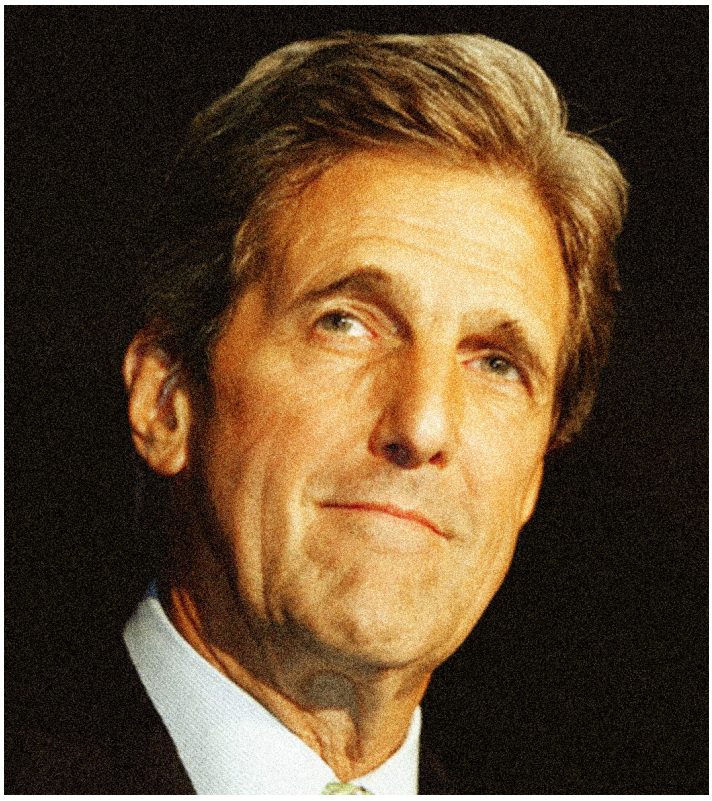
Dean said that in his class he aims to "establish a solid framework for decision-making and the most important parts of that are [for students] to be aware of their own biases, to be aware of their own interpersonal reactions to people because that influences the decision, and to think long term."

DeStefano said that he recognizes that breaking down barriers and confronting biases is difficult.

"I'm sure that sometimes as a seminar leader I'm attentive to it and sometimes I'm not attentive to it," he said.

Yale's resident politicians ultimately face the same challenges as other professors as they work to create open classrooms where students feel comfortable sharing their political beliefs, even if those opinions differ from the professor's politics.

"We are going to have different points of views about things," said DeStefano, "and folks need to learn to disagree without saying I'm making a value judgement about who you are and where you come from."



John Kerry '66, Former Secretary of State, will head the Kerry Initiative at Yale starting next year.

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